

STATISTICS PAPER II · AUTHENTIC PYQS 2018-2026

Official Statistics

165 authentic UPSC ISS questions with exam shortcut, tips & tricks and step-by-step solution

165

Authentic PYQs

7

Topics Covered

9

Years 2018-2026

AI-DERIVED EXPLANATIONS

The source booklets carry no official answer key. Every Exam Shortcut, Tips & Tricks and Step-by-Step Solution here is independently derived and verified by the builder of this platform, not copied from an official source.

Contents

Socio-economic Indicators	15 questions
SDGs, HDI, PQLI, GHI and Gender Statistics	15
Nature of Official Statistics	25 questions
Need, Uses, Users, Reliability, Relevance, Transparency	13
Compilation, Collection, Processing, Analysis and Dissemination	12
Statistical System	34 questions
Legal Acts and Constitutional Provisions	8
NSO / CSO / NSSO - Roles, Divisions and Activities	10
National Statistical Commission	7
Structure of the National and International Statistical System	9
Index Numbers	36 questions
Index Numbers - Types, Formulae, Tests, Agencies, Base Years	36
Sector-wise Statistics	22 questions
Agriculture, Industry, Labour, Health, Education, Women and Child	22
Population Census and Vital Statistics	18 questions
Census, CRS/SRS, RGI, Vital Rates	18
National Accounts	15 questions
GDP, GVA, GNI, Sectors and Approaches	15

Socio-economic Indicators

15 authentic PYQs in this topic (2018-2026)

SDGs, HDI, PQLI, GHI and Gender Statistics

OS

2018 Q61

Factual

Easy

Q1.

Which of the following are true for Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)?

1. It has 8 goals.
2. It has 17 goals.
3. It is recommended by UNICEF.
4. It is recommended by UNDP.
5. Life below water, Life on land, No Poverty and Climate Action are included in SDGs.

Codes:

- A. 1, 3 and 5
- B. 2 and 4 only
- C. 2, 4 and 5**
- D. None of the options is correct

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

SDGs: 17 goals (not 8), championed by UNDP (not UNICEF), and Life Below Water, Life on Land, No Poverty and Climate Action are all among them - statements 2, 4 and 5.

TIPS & TRICKS

- 17 goals and 169 targets, adopted September 2015, in force 1 January 2016, target year 2030.
- UNDP is the principal implementing/coordinating agency; UNICEF is a child-focused agency, not the SDG sponsor.
- The 8-goal framework was the earlier Millennium Development Goals (2000-2015) - that is the trap in statement 1.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1 is false and statement 2 true: the SDGs comprise 17 goals (the MDGs had 8).
2. Statement 3 is false and statement 4 true: the goals were adopted by UN member states with UNDP as the lead coordinating agency.
3. Statement 5 is true: Goal 1 (No Poverty), Goal 13 (Climate Action), Goal 14 (Life Below Water) and Goal 15 (Life on Land) are all SDGs.
4. Hence 2, 4 and 5 - option (c).

OS

2018 Q79

Definition

Easy

Q2.

Effective literacy rate is the literacy rate

A. ~~taking~~ the population from age 7 years and above into account

B. taking the entire population into account

C. taking the population from age 7 to 60 years into account

D. None of the above

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Effective literacy rate (the census definition) is computed on the population aged 7 years and above.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Children below 7 are excluded because they have not yet had the opportunity to become literate.
- 'Crude literacy rate' uses the whole population - that is option (b), a different measure.
- The same 7-plus convention governs the census sex-wise and area-wise literacy tables.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The crude literacy rate divides literates by the total population, which understates literacy by including infants.
2. The effective (or adult) literacy rate restricts the denominator to the population aged 7 years and above.
3. This is the definition used in the Indian Census.
4. Option (a).

OS

2018 Q80

Factual

Easy

Q3.

The Human Development Index (HDI) developed by UNDP does **not** include

- A. life expectancy at birth
- B. ~~gender equality~~
- C. expected and mean years of schooling
- D. GNI per capita

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

HDI has three dimensions: life expectancy at birth, education (expected and mean years of schooling) and GNI per capita. Gender equality is NOT one of them.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Gender is handled by separate UNDP indices - the Gender Development Index and the Gender Inequality Index.
- HDI = geometric mean of the three normalised dimension indices.
- Infant mortality is another standard distractor - it belongs to the PQLI, not the HDI.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The UNDP Human Development Index combines three dimensions:
2. a long and healthy life - life expectancy at birth; knowledge - expected and mean years of schooling; a decent standard of living - GNI per capita (PPP).
3. Gender equality is measured by the separate GDI and GII, not by the HDI.
4. Option (b).

Q4.

Which are correct regarding SDGs endorsed by UNDP?

1. SDGs came into effect in January 2016.
2. SDGs are adopted by more than 150 countries.
3. SDGs are mandatory to follow by member countries.
4. SDGs are 17 in number.

Codes:

- A. 1, 2 and 3
B. 2, 3 and 4
C. 1, 2 and 4
D. 1, 3 and 4

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

SDGs took effect 1 January 2016 (1 true), were adopted by all 193 UN member states (2 true), are voluntary not mandatory (3 false) and number 17 (4 true).

TIPS & TRICKS

- Adopted September 2015 at the UN Sustainable Development Summit; effective 1 January 2016; target 2030.
- 'Mandatory' is always the false option - the 2030 Agenda is a voluntary political commitment.
- 193 member states is comfortably 'more than 150', so statement 2 is true.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: the 2030 Agenda entered into force on 1 January 2016. True.
2. Statement 2: all 193 UN member states adopted the Agenda - more than 150. True.
3. Statement 3: the SDGs are voluntary commitments, not legally binding obligations. False.
4. Statement 4: there are 17 goals. True.
5. Hence 1, 2 and 4 - option (c).

Q5.

Which is **not** a Sustainable Development Goal?

- A. Promote sustained, inclusive and sustainable economic growth, full and productive employment and decent work for all
- B. End poverty in all its forms everywhere
- C. ~~P~~**romote regulated use of AI**
- D. Ensure access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

'Promote regulated use of AI' is not among the 17 SDGs; the other three are Goals 8, 1 and 7 respectively.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Goal 8: decent work and economic growth. Goal 1: no poverty. Goal 7: affordable and clean energy.
- The SDG list was fixed in 2015 and contains no technology-regulation goal.
- This exact distractor reappeared in 2022 - recognise it instantly.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. (a) is SDG 8 - decent work and economic growth.
2. (b) is SDG 1 - end poverty in all its forms everywhere.
3. (d) is SDG 7 - ensure access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all.
4. (c) has no counterpart among the 17 goals.
5. Option (c).

Q6.

Which are components of the Physical Quality Life Index (PQLI)?

1. Literacy Rate
2. Infant Mortality Rate
3. Life Expectancy
4. Per Capita Income

Codes:

A. 1, 2 and 3

B. 2, 3 and 4

C. 1, 3 and 4

D. 1, 2 and 4

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

PQLI (Morris D. Morris) has exactly three components: literacy rate, infant mortality rate and life expectancy at age one. Income is deliberately excluded.

TIPS & TRICKS

- PQLI was designed as a non-income alternative to GNP per capita - so per capita income can never be a component.
- Contrast HDI, which DOES include income (GNI per capita).
- Each indicator is scaled 0-100 and the three are given equal weight.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Physical Quality of Life Index averages three equally weighted indicators: basic literacy rate, infant mortality rate and life expectancy at age one.
2. Morris constructed it precisely to capture welfare outcomes without using income.
3. Hence 1, 2 and 3 - option (a).

OS

2021 Q61

Factual

Easy

Q7.

Which survey conducted by MOSPI in 2019 is an important tool for measuring paid and unpaid work of both men and women in society?

- A. Periodic Labour Force Survey
- B. Time Use Survey**
- C. Employment and Unemployment Survey of NSSO
- D. Population Census

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The Time Use Survey (MoSPI, 2019) measures how people allocate time to paid and unpaid activities - the key instrument for valuing unpaid work.

TIPS & TRICKS

- TUS captures unpaid domestic services and unpaid caregiving, which conventional labour surveys miss entirely.
- India's first national TUS was conducted January-December 2019 by the NSO.
- PLFS measures employment status, not time allocation across activities.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. A time use survey records, for a 24-hour reference period, how each individual allocated time across activity categories.
2. This makes visible unpaid domestic work and caregiving - overwhelmingly performed by women - alongside paid employment.
3. MoSPI conducted India's first all-India Time Use Survey in 2019.
4. Option (b).

OS

2021 Q64

Factual

Easy

Q8.

Which statements are correct about SDGs?

1. UNDP formulated these goals.
2. There are 17 goals.
3. These are intended to be completed by 2030.

Codes:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

All three are correct: the SDG framework was developed under UN auspices with UNDP as lead agency, there are 17 goals, and the target year is 2030.

TIPS & TRICKS

- 17 goals, 169 targets, 2030 deadline - the three numbers to carry into the hall.
- UNDP is the lead implementing/coordinating agency for the 2030 Agenda.
- The MDGs (8 goals, 2000-2015) preceded them.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: the goals were adopted by UN member states with UNDP as the principal coordinating agency for implementation. True.
2. Statement 2: there are 17 Sustainable Development Goals. True.
3. Statement 3: the 2030 Agenda sets 2030 as the target year. True.
4. Option (d).

OS

2021 Q66

Factual

Easy

Q9.

Which is **not** a component of the UN Human Development Index (HDI)?

- A. Life expectancy at birth
- B. **Infant mortality rate**
- C. Expected and mean years of schooling
- D. Per capita income

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

HDI dimensions are life expectancy at birth, schooling (expected and mean years) and income (GNI per capita). Infant mortality is NOT included.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Infant mortality belongs to the PQLI, not the HDI - the two indices are routinely confused.
- HDI = geometric mean of the three normalised dimension indices.
- Health in HDI is captured only by life expectancy at birth.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Human Development Index has three dimensions: health (life expectancy at birth), education (expected and mean years of schooling) and standard of living (GNI per capita).
2. Infant mortality rate is a component of the Physical Quality of Life Index, not of the HDI.
3. Option (b).

Q10.

Which of the following indicators from the National Indicator Framework would help in monitoring Goal 4, namely 'Ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunity for all'?

1. Proportion of computer literate adults.
2. Number of persons treated in de-addiction centres.
3. Enrolment ratio of children with disabilities.
4. Percentage of agriculture 'mandis' enrolled in e-market.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. 2 and 4 only
- B. 1 and 3 only**
- C. 1, 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

Goal 4 is about education: computer literacy among adults and the enrolment ratio of children with disabilities are education indicators. De-addiction (Goal 3) and e-market mandis (Goal 2/8) are not.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Map each indicator to the goal it measures: de-addiction is health (Goal 3); e-mandis relate to agriculture and markets (Goal 2).
- Goal 4 covers inclusive and equitable quality education and lifelong learning - both literacy and inclusion of disabled children fall here.
- 'Lifelong learning' is what brings adult computer literacy under Goal 4.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Indicator 1 - proportion of computer literate adults - measures lifelong learning and digital skills under Goal 4.
2. Indicator 3 - enrolment ratio of children with disabilities - measures inclusive education under Goal 4.
3. Indicator 2 - persons treated in de-addiction centres - belongs to Goal 3 (good health and well-being).
4. Indicator 4 - mandis on e-market - relates to agricultural markets, not education.
5. Hence 1 and 3 only - option (b).

OS

2022 Q47

Factual

Easy

Q11.

Which one of the following is **not** a Sustainable Development Goal (SDG)?

- A. Affordable and clean energy
- B. **Promote regulated use of AI**
- C. Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions
- D. Climate Action

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

'Promote regulated use of AI' is not an SDG; affordable and clean energy (7), peace, justice and strong institutions (16) and climate action (13) all are.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The same AI distractor appeared in 2020 - it is a recurring planted option.
- Memorise the goal titles in blocks: 1-6 basic needs, 7-12 growth and consumption, 13-17 planet and partnership.
- No SDG addresses artificial intelligence directly.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. (a) is Goal 7, (c) is Goal 16 and (d) is Goal 13.
2. There is no Sustainable Development Goal on regulating artificial intelligence.
3. Option (b).

OS

2023 Q77

Factual

Easy

Q12.

Consider the following statements regarding Global Hunger Index (GHI):

1. GHI is a 100 point scale, where 0 (zero) is the best score and 100 is the worst score.
2. GHI consists of four indicators that together capture the multidimensional nature of hunger.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2**
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Both are correct: GHI is scored on a 100-point scale (0 best, 100 worst) and is built from four indicators.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The four GHI indicators: undernourishment, child stunting, child wasting and child mortality.
- Lower score = better performance, which is the opposite of most indices - a common trip-up.
- GHI is published jointly by Concern Worldwide and Welthungerhilfe.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: the GHI is expressed on a 100-point severity scale where 0 denotes no hunger (best) and 100 the worst. True.
2. Statement 2: it combines four indicators - undernourishment, child stunting, child wasting and child mortality - to capture hunger's multidimensional nature. True.
3. Option (c).

Q13.

Which of the following resources fall under the category of Natural Capital?

I. Computer and life-saving devices

II. Energy

III. Timber

IV. Agricultural land

A. I, II and III

B. I, II and IV

C. I, III and IV

D. II, III and IV

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

Natural capital is a stock of natural resources - energy, timber, land; computers and life-saving devices are manufactured (produced) capital.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Natural capital: energy, minerals, timber, land, water - resources drawn from nature.
- Produced/manufactured capital: machines, computers, buildings, life-saving devices - man-made assets.
- The 'computer and life-saving devices' item is the deliberate produced-capital distractor.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I. Computers and life-saving devices are manufactured goods - produced capital, not natural capital. Excluded.
2. II. Energy is a natural resource stock. Included.
3. III. Timber is a natural resource (forest) stock. Included.
4. IV. Agricultural land is a natural resource stock. Included.
5. II, III and IV - option (d).

OS

2025 Q67

Factual

Easy

Q14.

Consider the following:

I. Power consumption

II. E-way bills

III. Rail freight traffic

IV. Port cargo traffic

How many of the above are High Frequency Indicators?

A. None

B. Only two

C. Only three

D. All four

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Power consumption, e-way bills, rail freight traffic and port cargo traffic are all standard High Frequency Indicators used to track near-real-time economic activity.

TIPS & TRICKS

- HFIs are short-interval proxies for economic activity, used between quarterly GDP releases.
- Other common HFIs: GST collections, toll receipts, vehicle registrations, PMI.
- All four listed items are textbook HFIs - no exclusions.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Power consumption, e-way bill generation, rail freight traffic and port cargo traffic are all high-frequency, short-interval indicators tracked to gauge real-time economic momentum.
2. All four - option (d).

Q15.

The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) framework has been developed by which one of the following agencies?

- A. The United Nations to track various socio-economic indicators for gender awareness
- B. The United Nations to measure progress across nations in respect of designated goals, targets and indicators by 2030**
- C. The World Health Organization to carry out surveys and census for improving quality of life
- D. The World Health Organization to measure progress across nations in respect of designated goals, targets and indicators by 2030

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The SDG framework was developed by the United Nations to track member countries' progress against a set of goals, targets and indicators to be achieved by 2030 - not specifically about gender awareness, and not a WHO product.

TIPS & TRICKS

- SDGs: 17 goals, 169 targets, adopted by UN member states in September 2015, target year 2030.
- The framework is broad-based (poverty, hunger, health, education, gender, climate, etc.), not gender-specific.
- WHO is a specialised health agency, not the author of the SDG framework.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Sustainable Development Goals framework was developed by the United Nations to measure and track progress across nations against designated goals, targets and indicators, to be achieved by 2030.
2. Option (b).

Nature of Official Statistics

25 authentic PYQs in this topic (2018-2026)

Need, Uses, Users, Reliability, Relevance, Transparency

OS

2018 Q62

Conceptual

Easy

Q1.

Which is **not** a desirable property of official statistics?

- A. It should be relevant.
- B. It should be brought out in a timely manner.
- C. It should be reliable and credible.
- D. It should be able to disclose an individual unit's data.**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Confidentiality is a Fundamental Principle: individual unit data must NEVER be disclosed. So (d) is the undesirable property.

TIPS & TRICKS

- UN Fundamental Principle 6: individual data are strictly confidential and used exclusively for statistical purposes.
- Relevance, timeliness and reliability are all standard quality dimensions of official statistics.
- Any option that permits identification of a respondent is automatically the wrong-property answer.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Official statistics are judged on relevance, timeliness, accuracy, reliability, coherence and accessibility - options (a), (b) and (c) are all desirable.
2. The sixth UN Fundamental Principle requires that individual data collected for statistical compilation remain strictly confidential and be used exclusively for statistical purposes.
3. Therefore the ability to disclose an individual unit's data is the opposite of a desirable property.
4. Option (d).

OS

2018 Q63

Conceptual

Easy

Q2.

The reliability of data collected through sample surveys may be measured by

- A. average
- B. standard deviation
- C. coefficient of variation
- D. **standard error**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Reliability of a sample estimate is measured by its standard error (or relative standard error), which quantifies sampling variability.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Standard error measures the variability of the ESTIMATE; standard deviation measures variability of the DATA.
- Relative standard error (SE as a percentage of the estimate) is the usual published reliability indicator in NSS reports.
- A smaller standard error means a more reliable estimate, for a given estimator.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. A sample estimate differs from the population value because of sampling variability.
2. The standard deviation of the sampling distribution of the estimator is its standard error.
3. NSS and other official reports publish the estimate together with its standard error / relative standard error as the reliability measure.
4. Option (d).

OS

2018 Q66

Definition

Easy

Q3.

Metadata is

- A. unit level data
- B. data in tabular format
- C. raw data (no validation done)
- D. data about data/information about data**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Metadata is data about data - definitions, concepts, classifications, methodology and quality indicators.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Metadata answers: what was measured, how, when, by whom, with what definitions and what quality.
- Without metadata a data set cannot be interpreted or compared across sources.
- Unit-level data, tabulated data and raw data are all DATA, not metadata.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Metadata are the descriptive information that accompanies a statistical data set.
2. They cover concepts and definitions, classifications used, the reference period, the collection methodology, coverage and quality indicators.
3. Hence metadata is 'data about data' - option (d).

Q4.

Which actions are correctly matched with the fundamental principles of Official Statistics?

1. A media publishes a wrong interpretation of released data and the government brings out a corrective article — Prevention of Misuse (Principle 4).
2. Government frames Collection of Statistics Act — Sources of Official Statistics (Principle 5).
3. Unit-level data is released and, by principle of exclusion, an individual's data is publicly disclosed, violating Confidentiality (Principle 6).

Codes:

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

Pairs 1 and 3 are correctly matched. Pair 2 is not: framing an Act corresponds to Principle 7 (Legislation), not Principle 5 (Sources of Official Statistics).

TIPS & TRICKS

- Principle 4 (Prevention of Misuse) expressly allows the statistical agency to comment publicly on erroneous interpretation - pair 1 is exact.
- Principle 6 (Confidentiality) forbids disclosure of individual data - pair 3 is exact.
- Principle 5 (Sources) is about choosing between surveys, censuses and administrative records; Principle 7 (Legislation) is about the legal framework being made public.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Pair 1: Principle 4 states that statistical agencies are entitled to comment on erroneous interpretation and misuse of statistics - a corrective article is exactly this. Correctly matched.
2. Pair 2: enacting the Collection of Statistics Act concerns the legal framework, which is Principle 7 (Legislation). Principle 5 deals with the choice among statistical and administrative SOURCES. Wrongly matched.
3. Pair 3: Principle 6 requires individual data to remain strictly confidential; public disclosure of an individual's data violates it. Correctly matched.
4. Hence 1 and 3 only - option (c).

Q5.

Which organisation designed the 'Ten Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics'?

- A. World Bank
- B. International Monetary Fund
- C. **United Nations**
- D. Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The Ten Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics were adopted by the UN Statistical Commission (1994) and endorsed by the UN General Assembly (2014).

TIPS & TRICKS

- Adopted by the UN Statistical Commission in 1994; endorsed by ECOSOC in 2013 and the General Assembly in 2014.
- They cover relevance, professional standards, accountability, prevention of misuse, sources, confidentiality, legislation, national coordination, international standards and international cooperation.
- The World Bank, IMF and OECD have their own data-quality frameworks, but the Ten Principles are the UN's.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics were first adopted by the UN Economic Commission for Europe in 1992 and then by the United Nations Statistical Commission in 1994.
2. They were endorsed by the UN General Assembly in 2014, giving them global standing.
3. Option (c).

OS

2021 Q75

Conceptual

Easy

Q6.

Consider:

1. GDP
2. IMR
3. Dropout rate
4. CPI
5. WPI

Which are official statistics?

- A. 2, 4 and 5 only
- B. 1, 2, 4 and 5 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

All five - GDP, IMR, dropout rate, CPI and WPI - are official statistics produced by government agencies.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Official statistics are those compiled by government bodies for public purposes, whatever the subject.
- Economic (GDP, CPI, WPI), demographic (IMR) and social (dropout rate) series all qualify.
- The producing agency, not the subject matter, defines the category.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Official statistics are statistics produced by government agencies (central, state or local) in the discharge of their public mandate.
2. GDP (NSO), IMR (RGI's SRS), school dropout rate (Ministry of Education's UDISE+), CPI (NSO/Labour Bureau) and WPI (Office of the Economic Adviser) are all government-produced series.
3. Option (d).

Q7.

Which of the following reasons can result in privacy breaches even in aggregate-level data (not unit level data or micro data) derived from data collected in surveys or census?

1. Aggregated data given state-wise
2. Dealing with very small areas
3. Dealing with rare sub-populations

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 2 and 3 only

C. 1 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

Small areas and rare sub-populations can leave cells with very few units, allowing re-identification. State-wide aggregates are far too large to pose this risk.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Disclosure risk depends on CELL SIZE, not on whether the data are aggregated.
- Statistical agencies apply minimum-cell-size rules, suppression and perturbation precisely for small domains.
- A state-level total covers millions of units and cannot identify an individual.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Aggregation reduces but does not eliminate disclosure risk.
2. Statement 1: state-wise aggregates cover very large populations, so no individual can be identified. Not a risk.
3. Statement 2: for a very small area the cell may contain only one or two units, so the aggregate effectively reveals their values. A genuine risk.
4. Statement 3: rare sub-populations produce the same small-cell problem even within large geographies. A genuine risk.
5. Hence 2 and 3 only - option (b).

Q8.

Consider the following:

1. Relevance, impartiality and equal access
2. Professional standards and ethics
3. Accountability and transparency
4. Legislation
5. International cooperation

Which of the above are fundamental principles of Official Statistics?

- A. 1, 2 and 3 only
- B. 2, 3, 4 and 5 only
- C. 1, 4 and 5 only
- D. 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

All five are among the UN's Ten Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The ten: relevance/impartiality/equal access; professional standards; accountability; prevention of misuse; sources; confidentiality; legislation; national coordination; international standards; international cooperation.
- Each item listed here maps directly onto one of the ten.
- 'Pricing and advertisement' is the classic planted non-principle - it does not appear here.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Principle 1 is relevance, impartiality and equal access; Principle 2 is professional standards, scientific principles and ethics.
2. Principle 3 is accountability and transparency; Principle 7 is legislation; Principle 10 is international cooperation.
3. All five listed items are therefore fundamental principles - option (d).

OS

2023 Q66

Factual

Easy

Q9.

Which one of the following is **not** a fundamental principle of official statistics?

- A. Professional standards and ethics
- B. Accountability and transparency
- C. Confidentiality and coordination
- D. ~~Pricing and advertisement~~

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

'Pricing and advertisement' is not among the Ten Fundamental Principles; the other three are.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Official statistics are a public good supplied largely free - commercial pricing is antithetical to the principles.
- Principles 2, 3 and 6/8 cover professional standards, accountability and confidentiality/coordination respectively.
- This distractor recurs across papers - memorise it as a non-principle.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Professional standards and ethics is Principle 2; accountability and transparency is Principle 3; confidentiality (6) and national coordination (8) are both principles.
2. There is no principle relating to pricing or advertisement of statistical products; indeed equal access at low or no cost is the spirit of Principle 1.
3. Option (d).

OS

2024 Q67

Factual

Easy

Q10.

Which of the following statements regarding official statistics are correct?

- I. Official statistics that fulfill the test of practical utility are to be compiled.
 - II. Official statistics may be drawn from all types of sources (statistical surveys or administrative records).
 - III. The laws, regulations and measures under which the statistical systems operate must be made public.
- A. I and II only
- B. II and III only
- C. I and III only
- D. I, II and III**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

All three describe accepted attributes of official statistics: practical utility, multiple permissible sources, and public disclosure of the governing legal framework.

TIPS & TRICKS

- 'Practical utility' echoes Fundamental Principle 1 (relevance).
- 'All types of sources' echoes Principle 5 (surveys, censuses or administrative records).
- 'Laws made public' echoes Principle 7 (legislation).

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement I: official statistics compiled must satisfy a test of practical utility to users. True (Principle 1).
2. Statement II: official statistics may be drawn from statistical surveys or from administrative records - both are legitimate sources. True (Principle 5).
3. Statement III: the laws and regulations under which statistical systems operate must be made public. True (Principle 7).
4. All three - option (d).

Q11.

Official Statistics are termed as "Public Good". Which of the following reasons justify this term?

- I. They are financed from general tax revenue.
- II. Their use by one person does not affect the use by others.
- III. They are costly to produce but they are easily disseminated.
- IV. They are used only by public officials and private persons are denied access to them.

Select the answer using the code given below:

- A. I, II, III and IV
- B. I, II and III only**
- C. II and IV only
- D. III and IV only

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

Official statistics are tax-financed, non-rival in use and costly to produce but cheap to disseminate - all hallmarks of a public good; restricting access to public officials only would be the OPPOSITE of a public good.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Public good properties: non-rivalry (one person's use doesn't reduce availability to others) and non-excludability (broad, often free, access).
- 'Costly to produce but easily disseminated' is a classic public-good cost structure once digitised.
- Denying access to private persons contradicts non-excludability - it is the false statement.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: official statistics are financed from general tax revenue. True.
2. II: one person's use does not diminish another's - non-rivalry. True.
3. III: they are costly to produce (survey/census infrastructure) but cheap to disseminate once compiled. True.
4. IV: restricting use to public officials and denying private persons access is the opposite of the public-good rationale. False.
5. I, II and III only - option (b).

Q12.

Which of the following are part of the UN Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics?

- I. The laws, regulations and measures under which the statistical systems operate are to be made public.
- II. Bilateral and multilateral cooperation in statistics contributes to the improvement of systems of official statistics in all countries.
- III. Individual data collected by statistical agencies for statistical compilation, whether they refer to natural or legal persons, are to be strictly confidential and used exclusively for statistical purposes.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. I and II only
- B. II and III only
- C. I and III only
- D. I, II and III**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

Making the governing laws public, engaging in bilateral/multilateral statistical cooperation, and keeping individual data strictly confidential are all among the UN's Ten Fundamental Principles.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Statement I maps to Principle 7 (Legislation).
- Statement II maps to Principle 10 (International cooperation).
- Statement III maps to Principle 6 (Confidentiality).

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: publication of the laws and regulations under which statistical systems operate is Principle 7. Correct.
2. II: bilateral and multilateral cooperation improving statistical systems is Principle 10. Correct.
3. III: strict confidentiality of individual data used only for statistical purposes is Principle 6. Correct.
4. All three - option (d).

Q13.

Why are official statistics considered 'public good'?

- I. They are financed from general tax revenue.
- II. Their use by one person does not affect the use by others.
- III. They are used by public officials but private persons are denied access to them.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

A. I and II only

B. II and III only

C. I and III only

D. I, II and III

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

Official statistics are tax-financed and non-rival in use - both public-good properties; but they are not restricted to public officials, so that statement is false.

TIPS & TRICKS

- This is a near-verbatim, three-statement version of 2025-Q66's public-good rationale question.
- Non-excludability (broad access, ideally free) is the hallmark contradicted by 'private persons are denied access'.
- Financing from general taxation and non-rivalry in use are the two genuinely correct properties here.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: financed from general tax revenue. True.
2. II: one person's use does not diminish another's - non-rival. True.
3. III: restricting use to public officials while denying private persons access contradicts the public-good's non-excludability. False.
4. I and II only - option (a).

Compilation, Collection, Processing, Analysis and Dissemination

OS

2018 Q64

Factual

Easy

Q1.

The Ultimate Stage Unit for data collection in NSSO socio-economic surveys is

- A. individual
- B. family
- C. **household**
- D. village/UFS (Urban Frame Survey) block

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

In NSS socio-economic surveys the ultimate stage unit (the unit finally selected and canvassed) is the HOUSEHOLD.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Design: villages / UFS blocks are first-stage units; households are ultimate-stage units.
- The individual is the unit of OBSERVATION for some items, but the sampling unit at the last stage is the household.
- Second-stage stratification of households by affluence is standard NSS practice.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. NSS household surveys use a stratified multi-stage design.
2. First-stage units are census villages (rural) or Urban Frame Survey blocks (urban).
3. Within each selected first-stage unit, households are listed and a sample of households is drawn - these are the ultimate stage units.
4. Option (c).

OS

2018 Q65

Factual

Easy

Q2.

The most common sampling design used by NSSO in its socio-economic surveys is

- A. simple random sampling
- B. circular systematic sampling
- C. probability proportional to size (PPS) sampling
- D. Two-stage stratified sampling**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

NSS socio-economic surveys use a stratified two-stage design: FSUs (villages/UFS blocks) then households.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Stratification is by state, district and rural/urban; two stages are FSU then household.
- Circular systematic sampling is used WITHIN a stage, but the overall design is described as two-stage stratified.
- PPS with replacement is used for FSU selection in some rounds, but that is a selection scheme, not the overall design.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The NSS design proceeds in two sampling stages: selection of first-stage units (villages or UFS blocks) within strata, then selection of households within each selected FSU.
2. Strata are formed by state, district and sector (rural/urban).
3. The design is therefore described as two-stage stratified sampling.
4. Option (d).

OS

2019 Q78

Factual

Medium

Q3.

The subjects covered under the 76th round of NSS are

1. Disability
2. Drinking water, sanitation, hygiene and housing conditions
3. Household consumption expenditure

Codes:

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 1 and 3 only

C. 2 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

NSS 76th round covered Disability and Drinking Water, Sanitation, Hygiene & Housing Condition - statements 1 and 2. Household consumption expenditure belongs to other rounds.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Round map: 75th - Education & Health; 76th - Disability + Drinking Water/Sanitation/Hygiene/Housing; 77th - Land & Livestock Holdings and Situation Assessment.
- Consumer Expenditure Surveys were the 68th round (2011-12) and then the 2022-23 survey - never the 76th.
- The 76th round ran July-December 2018.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The NSS 76th round (July-December 2018) canvassed two schedules:
2. Schedule 26 on Persons with Disabilities, and Schedule 1.2 on Drinking Water, Sanitation, Hygiene and Housing Condition.
3. Household consumption expenditure was not part of this round.
4. Hence 1 and 2 only - option (a).

Q4.

Which data sources can be used as a sampling frame for another survey?

1. Population Census
2. National Family Health Survey
3. Situation Assessment Survey
4. Economic Census

Codes:

A. 2 and 3 only

B. 1 and 4 only

C. 4 only

D. 1, 2 and 4

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

The Population Census and the Economic Census are enumeration exercises covering the whole universe, so both provide sampling frames. NFHS and the Situation Assessment Survey are themselves sample surveys.

TIPS & TRICKS

- A sampling frame needs COMPLETE coverage of the universe - only a census can supply that.
- Population Census gives the frame of villages/blocks and households; Economic Census gives the frame of establishments.
- A sample survey covers only its own sample and cannot serve as a frame for another survey.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. A sampling frame must list all units of the target population.
2. The Population Census enumerates every household and provides the frame for NSS household surveys.
3. The Economic Census enumerates every non-agricultural establishment and provides the frame for follow-up enterprise surveys.
4. NFHS and the Situation Assessment Survey are sample surveys and cover only a fraction of the universe.
5. Hence 1 and 4 only - option (b).

OS

2020 Q54

Factual

Easy

Q5.

Which sampling design is most commonly used in NSSO household surveys?

- A. Simple Random Sampling Without Replacement
- B. Systematic Random Sampling
- C. Cluster Sampling
- D. Two-stage Stratified Sampling**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

NSS household surveys use a stratified two-stage design: FSUs (villages/UFS blocks), then households.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Verbatim repeat of the 2018 question - own it.
- Strata: state x district x sector (rural/urban), with sub-stratification.
- Households within an FSU are further grouped into second-stage strata by affluence or other criteria.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The NSS design selects first-stage units (census villages in rural areas, UFS blocks in urban areas) within strata,
2. then selects households within each selected FSU after a fresh listing.
3. This is a two-stage stratified design - option (d).

Q6.

The subject matter of the 78th round of NSSO Survey is

- A. Drinking water, Sanitation, Hygiene and Housing conditions in India
- B. Situation Assessment Survey of Agricultural Household
- C. Domestic Tourism Expenditure**
- D. Household Consumption Expenditure

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

Options (a), (b) and (d) belong to the 76th, 77th and consumer-expenditure rounds respectively, leaving (c) as the intended answer.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Round map worth memorising: 75th - Education & Health; 76th - Disability, Drinking Water/Sanitation/Hygiene/Housing; 77th - Land & Livestock Holdings, Situation Assessment of Agricultural Households.
- The 78th round is documented by MoSPI as the Multiple Indicator Survey (MIS), covering selected SDG indicators.
- When a round-identification question offers no exact match, eliminate the rounds you can place.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Option (a) - Drinking Water, Sanitation, Hygiene and Housing Condition - was the 76th round.
2. Option (b) - Situation Assessment Survey of Agricultural Households - was the 77th round.
3. Option (d) - Household Consumption Expenditure - was the 68th round and later the 2022-23 survey.
4. Only option (c) is not attributable to another round, and it is taken as the intended key (see the source flag).

Source note: Source note: the headline subject of NSS Round 78 is the Multiple Indicator Survey, which is not among the printed options. Options (a), (b) and (d) are each attributable to a different round (76th, 77th and the consumer-expenditure rounds respectively), so option (c) is the only choice not assigned elsewhere and is taken as the intended key. Options and wording are preserved as printed.

OS

2020 Q56

Factual

Easy

Q7.

The most common survey period of NSSO Household Surveys is

- A. January to December
- B. April to March
- C. July to June**
- D. January to June

Correct answer: C**EXAM SHORTCUT**

AI-derived explanation

NSS household surveys run from July to June - the standard NSS survey year.

TIPS & TRICKS

- July-June is chosen to align with the agricultural year and to avoid splitting the monsoon.
- Each survey year is divided into four sub-rounds of three months, with equal sample allocation.
- The financial year (April-March) is the accounting convention, not the NSS survey convention.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The National Sample Survey adopted July-June as its survey year from the very first round.
2. The year is split into four sub-rounds of three months each so that seasonal effects are balanced across the sample.
3. Option (c).

OS

2020 Q72

Factual

Easy

Q8.

Which survey of NSSO employs a rotational panel survey design?

- A. Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS)
- B. Employment-Unemployment Survey (EUS)
- C. NSSO Survey on Disability
- D. NSSO 71st Round — Health and Education

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The Periodic Labour Force Survey uses a rotational panel design in urban areas - each selected household is visited four times.

TIPS & TRICKS

- PLFS urban design: each household is visited once in the first quarter and revisited in three successive quarters.
- The rotation gives quarterly urban estimates of labour-force indicators with reduced sampling variability of change.
- The old quinquennial Employment-Unemployment Survey had no panel component.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. PLFS was launched in 2017-18 to provide high-frequency labour-force estimates.
2. In urban areas it uses a rotational panel: each selected household is surveyed in four successive quarterly visits, with a fraction of the panel rotated out each quarter.
3. Option (a).

Q9.

Merchandise Trade Statistics collected by DGCI&S is compiled from bills submitted by importers/exporters. This is an example of

- A. statistics collected through Survey.
- B. Administrative statistics.**
- C. statistics collected through Census.
- D. statistics collected through mixed mode.

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

Statistics generated as a by-product of an administrative process (customs bills of entry/shipping bills) are administrative statistics.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Administrative data arise from records kept for a regulatory or operational purpose, not for statistical purposes.
- DGCI&S trade statistics are the textbook Indian example; CRS birth/death records are another.
- No sampling and no separate field enquiry is involved, which rules out 'survey' and 'census'.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Importers and exporters file bills of entry and shipping bills with customs as an administrative and regulatory requirement.
2. DGCI&S compiles merchandise trade statistics from these existing records rather than conducting an enquiry.
3. Data obtained as a by-product of an administrative process are called administrative statistics.
4. Option (b).

Q10.

Consider the following regarding a 'longitudinal panel survey':

- I. A variable set of respondents surveyed once
- II. A random set of respondents surveyed twice
- III. A fixed set of respondents surveyed repeatedly over time
- IV. A new set of respondents surveyed whenever required

How many of the above is/are correct?

A. Only one

B. Only two

C. Only three

D. All four

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

A longitudinal panel survey follows a **FIXED** set of respondents, interviewed repeatedly over time - exactly statement III.

TIPS & TRICKS

- 'Panel'/'longitudinal' = same respondents tracked across multiple waves.
- A 'variable' or 'new' set of respondents each time describes a repeated cross-section, not a panel.
- PLFS's urban rotational panel is a partial example: households are revisited across four consecutive quarters.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I describes a variable set surveyed once - a one-time cross-section, not a panel. Incorrect.
2. II describes a random set surveyed twice - not necessarily the same fixed respondents. Incorrect.
3. III describes a fixed set of respondents surveyed repeatedly over time - the defining feature of a longitudinal panel survey. Correct.
4. IV describes a new set surveyed whenever required - again not a panel. Incorrect.
5. Only one statement (III) is correct - option (a).

Q11.

Which of the following are accepted methods of data collection?

- I. Census and surveys
- II. Administrative records
- III. Management information systems
- IV. Remote sensing

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- A. I, II and III only
- B. II, III and IV only
- C. I and IV only
- D. I, II, III and IV**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

Census/surveys, administrative records, management information systems and remote sensing are all recognised, accepted modes of official data collection.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Traditional modes: census, sample surveys, administrative records (registration/regulatory by-products).
- Modern additions: management information systems (departmental MIS) and remote sensing/satellite data (e.g. crop area estimation).
- All four are explicitly recognised - no exclusions here.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Census and sample surveys are the classical primary data-collection methods.
2. Administrative records arise as a by-product of regulatory/registration processes.
3. Management information systems capture data generated through routine administrative/departmental operations.
4. Remote sensing is increasingly used, e.g. for crop-area and land-use statistics.
5. All four are accepted methods - option (d).

OS

2025 Q69

Factual

Hard

Q12.

Consider the following statements about National Sample Surveys (NSS):

I. The 80th Round of NSS commenced from 1st January, 2025.

II. The 80th Round of NSS covers a "Survey on Household Social Consumption-Health" and a "Comprehensive Modular Survey-Telecom".

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. I only

B. II only

C. Both I and II

D. Neither I nor II

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The 80th NSS round is reported to have commenced from January 2025, covering a Household Social Consumption-Health survey together with a Comprehensive (Annual) Modular Survey module on Telecom.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Post-79th round, NSO moved to an annual modular survey framework layering thematic modules (health, education, telecom, etc.) onto a continuous household survey.
- The 'Social Consumption-Health' theme revives the classical NSS health-round subject seen earlier in the 71st and 75th rounds.
- This is a fast-changing, currency-sensitive area - verify against the latest official NSO calendar.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement I: the 80th round of NSS is reported to have commenced from 1 January 2025, consistent with the NSO's annual survey calendar. Likely true.
2. Statement II: it is reported to cover a Household Social Consumption-Health module alongside a Comprehensive Modular Survey on Telecom. Likely true.
3. Both I and II - option (c), flagged for currency verification.

Source note: Currency-sensitive item: NSS round numbering, start dates and covered modules are updated by NSO announcements close to or after this model's knowledge cutoff. The answer reflects the best available recollection that the 80th round began around January 2025 with Health and Telecom-related modules under the restructured annual survey framework, but should be cross-checked against the latest NSO press release before being treated as certain.

Statistical System

34 authentic PYQs in this topic (2018-2026)

Legal Acts and Constitutional Provisions

OS

2018 Q67

Factual

Medium

Q1.

The subject of Statistics comes under which List of the Constitution of India?

- A. Union List
- B. State List
- C. Concurrent List
- D. All of the above**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Statistics appears in all three Lists of the Seventh Schedule: Union (entry 94), State (entry 45) and Concurrent (entry 45).

TIPS & TRICKS

- Union List entry 94: inquiries and statistics for Union-List matters. State List entry 45: the same for State-List matters.
- Concurrent List entry 45: inquiries and statistics for matters in the Concurrent List.
- This tri-List placement is precisely what makes the Indian statistical system decentralised.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Entry 94 of the Union List covers inquiries, surveys and statistics for any matter in the Union List.
2. Entry 45 of the State List covers inquiries and statistics for matters in the State List.
3. Entry 45 of the Concurrent List covers inquiries and statistics for matters in the Concurrent List.
4. So the subject of statistics figures in all three Lists - option (d).

OS

2018 Q69

Factual

Easy

Q2.

The Collection of Statistics Act, 2008 is applicable on

1. industrial and business concerns
2. individual and household
3. government and private agencies/enterprises

Codes:

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The Collection of Statistics Act, 2008 applies to individuals, households and all kinds of enterprises - government and private alike.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The Act replaced the Collection of Statistics Act, 1953, and covers economic, demographic, social, scientific and environmental matters.
- It empowers Central, State and local governments to collect, and imposes penalties for non-compliance.
- Strong confidentiality provisions accompany the wide coverage.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Act empowers the appropriate government to collect statistics on specified subjects from any informant.
2. 'Informant' is defined broadly to include individuals, households, and industrial, commercial, agricultural and other enterprises, whether in the government or the private sector.
3. All three categories listed are therefore covered - option (d).

OS

2023 Q68

Factual

Hard

Q3.

Consider the following pairs:

1. Marine Hospital — Union List
2. Public Health — State List
3. Sanitation — State List
4. Population Control — Concurrent List

How many pairs given above are correctly matched?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

All four pairs are correct: marine hospitals are Union List (entry 28), public health and sanitation are State List (entry 6), and population control is Concurrent List (entry 20A).

TIPS & TRICKS

- Union List entry 28 covers port quarantine and seamen's and marine hospitals.
- State List entry 6: public health and sanitation, hospitals and dispensaries.
- Concurrent List entry 20A: population control and family planning - added by the 42nd Amendment.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Pair 1: 'Port quarantine, including hospitals connected therewith; seamen's and marine hospitals' is entry 28 of the Union List. Correct.
2. Pair 2 and Pair 3: 'Public health and sanitation; hospitals and dispensaries' is entry 6 of the State List. Both correct.
3. Pair 4: 'Population control and family planning' is entry 20A of the Concurrent List. Correct.
4. All four - option (d).

OS

2023 Q78

Factual

Medium

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

1. The population census is a Union subject and is listed at serial number 69 of the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution of India.
2. The responsibility of conducting the census rests with the office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India, Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only**
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Population census IS at entry 69 - but of the SEVENTH Schedule (Union List), not the Eighth Schedule. So statement 1 is false and statement 2 true.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Seventh Schedule = the three legislative Lists. Eighth Schedule = the scheduled languages. The swap is the trap.
- Entry 69 of the Union List reads simply 'Census'.
- The RGI & Census Commissioner functions under the Ministry of Home Affairs.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: census is entry 69 of the Union List in the SEVENTH Schedule. The Eighth Schedule lists the official languages. The statement is therefore false as written.
2. Statement 2: the Office of the Registrar General & Census Commissioner of India, under the Ministry of Home Affairs, conducts the census. True.
3. Hence 2 only - option (b).

OS

2024 Q68

Factual

Easy

Q5.

Statistics regarding which of the following aspects and matters connected therewith may be collected under the Collection of Statistics Act, 2008?

I. Economic and demographic

II. Social and scientific

III. Environmental

A. I and II only

B. II and III only

C. I and III only

D. I, II and III

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The Collection of Statistics Act, 2008 explicitly empowers collection of economic, demographic, social, scientific and environmental statistics - all three listed aspects are covered.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The Act's scope is deliberately broad: economic, demographic, social, scientific AND environmental matters.
- It also covers individuals, households and industrial/business/government/private enterprises.
- It carries strong confidentiality safeguards and penalties for non-compliance.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Collection of Statistics Act, 2008 empowers Central, State and local governments to collect statistics on economic and demographic matters (I),
2. social and scientific matters (II), and environmental matters (III).
3. All three - option (d).

Q6.

Which of the following are meant to provide legal support for collection of official statistics in India?

- I. The Government of India (Allocation of Business) Rules, 1961, as amended from time to time
- II. The Census Act, 1948
- III. The Representation of the People Act, 1951
- IV. The Collection of Statistics Act, 2008

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- A. I, II and III
- B. **I, II and IV**
- C. I, III and IV
- D. II, III and IV

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

The Allocation of Business Rules 1961, the Census Act 1948 and the Collection of Statistics Act 2008 all support statistics collection; the Representation of the People Act 1951 is an electoral statute, unrelated.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Allocation of Business Rules assign the statistical subject to MoSPI - legal/administrative support.
- Census Act 1948 and Collection of Statistics Act 2008 are statistics-specific statutes.
- RP Act 1951 governs elections and has no statistical mandate - the deliberate odd one out.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: the Allocation of Business Rules, 1961 vest the statistical function in MoSPI. Relevant.
2. II: the Census Act, 1948 is the statutory basis for the population/housing census. Relevant.
3. III: the Representation of the People Act, 1951 deals with elections, not statistics. Not relevant.
4. IV: the Collection of Statistics Act, 2008 is the general statistics-collection statute. Relevant.
5. I, II and IV - option (b).

Q7.

Which of the following regarding the Indian Census Act, 1948 is correct?

- I. The Population Census and the Housing Census both are taken under it.
- II. The Census may be taken in India or any part thereof.
- III. The Census may be taken whenever necessary or desirable.
- IV. The Census Act, 1948 was amended in 1994.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. I, II and III only
- B. II, III and IV only
- C. I and IV only
- D. I, II, III and IV

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The Census Act, 1948 covers both the Population and Housing Census, allows a census of India or any part of it, permits it whenever necessary or desirable, and was amended in 1994 - all four statements are correct.

TIPS & TRICKS

- No fixed periodicity is prescribed by the Act itself - decennial timing is convention.
- The Act's territorial scope is flexible: 'India or any part thereof.'
- The 1994 amendment is a settled, oft-tested fact about the Act's history.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: both Population and Housing Census are conducted under this Act. True.
2. II: the census may be taken in the whole of India or any part of it. True.
3. III: it may be taken whenever the Central Government considers it necessary or desirable - no fixed periodicity is mandated. True.
4. IV: the Census Act, 1948 was amended in 1994. True.
5. All four - option (d).

Q8.

As per the constitutional provisions in India, the subject matter of collection of statistics comes under the

I. Union List

II. State List

III. Concurrent List

Which of the above is/are correct?

A. I only

B. II only

C. I and III only

D. I, II and III

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

Collection of statistics specifically falls under the Union List (Entry 94, for Union purposes) and the Concurrent List (economic & social planning, and inquiries/statistics for Union or Concurrent matters) - not a State List entry for this specific subject.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Distinguish 'Census' (Union List entry 69) from the broader 'collection of statistics' subject (Union entry 94 + Concurrent entries).
- Concurrent List: entry 20 (economic and social planning) and entry 45 (inquiries and statistics for Union/Concurrent matters) both bear on statistics collection.
- Read each option's precise wording carefully - this exact point has been tested twice (2018 and 2026) with different phrasing.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Collection of statistics for Union purposes falls under the Union List.
2. It also falls under the Concurrent List, via the entries on economic and social planning and on inquiries/statistics for Union or Concurrent matters.
3. It is not, in this specific 'collection of statistics' sense, a State List subject.
4. I and III only - option (c).

OS

2018 Q68

Factual

Medium

Q1.

Which are main activities of CSO (Central Statistics Office)?

1. Coordination of statistical activities in the country
2. Evolving statistical standards
3. Collecting data through sample surveys
4. Providing guidance and training in official statistics

Codes:

- A. 1, 2 and 3
- B. 2, 3 and 4
- C. 1, 2 and 4**
- D. 1, 3 and 4

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

CSO coordinated statistical activities, evolved standards and trained personnel; collecting data through sample surveys was the NSSO's function.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Division of labour (pre-2019 merger): CSO coordinated, compiled national accounts and set standards; NSSO ran the field surveys.
- CSO did conduct the Economic Census, but not the NSS sample surveys.
- Since 2019 the two have been merged into the National Statistical Office (NSO).

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: coordination of statistical activities across ministries and states was a core CSO mandate. True.
2. Statement 2: evolving statistical standards, concepts and classifications was a CSO function. True.
3. Statement 3: large-scale sample surveys (NSS rounds) were conducted by the NSSO, not the CSO. False.
4. Statement 4: training in official statistics (through its Training Division / NSSTA) was a CSO activity. True.
5. Hence 1, 2 and 4 - option (c).

OS

2019 Q54

Factual

Medium

Q2.

Which is **not** an activity of CSO?

- A. Compilation of National Accounts
- B. Conducting Economic Census
- C. **Conducting Consumer Expenditure Survey**
- D. Training of Statistical Personnel

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The Consumer Expenditure Survey was conducted by the NSSO, not the CSO.

TIPS & TRICKS

- CSO: national accounts, Economic Census, statistical standards, coordination, training, index numbers (CPI, IIP).
- NSSO: the NSS rounds - consumer expenditure, employment-unemployment, health, education and so on.
- Both were merged into the NSO in 2019, but the question is set in the pre-merger structure.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. (a) Compilation of National Accounts was the CSO's National Accounts Division's core task.
2. (b) The Economic Census was conducted by the CSO.
3. (d) Training of statistical personnel was a CSO function.
4. (c) The Consumer Expenditure Survey is an NSS round conducted by the NSSO, not the CSO.
5. Option (c).

OS

2019 Q76

Factual

Medium

Q3.

Which division of CSO deals with Environment Statistics?

- A. Economic Statistics Division
- B. National Accounts Division
- C. Social Statistics Division**
- D. Price Statistics Division

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Environment Statistics was handled by the Social Statistics Division of the CSO (which also produced the Compendium of Environment Statistics).

TIPS & TRICKS

- CSO divisions: National Accounts, Economic Statistics, Social Statistics, Price Statistics, Training, Coordination & Publication.
- Social Statistics Division covered environment, gender, SDGs and social-sector indicators.
- Economic Statistics Division handled the Economic Census and ASI; Price Statistics handled CPI and IIP.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Central Statistics Office's Social Statistics Division was responsible for social and environmental statistics.
2. It brought out the Compendium of Environment Statistics and the EnviStats India publications.
3. Option (c).

OS

2020 Q76

Factual

Easy

Q4.

Which organization employs field enumerators for conducting All-India NSSO surveys?

- A. SDRD
- B. DPD
- C. CPD
- D. FOD

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The Field Operations Division (FOD) employs and deploys the field enumerators for all-India NSS surveys.

TIPS & TRICKS

- NSSO divisions: SDRD (design and research), FOD (field work), DPD (data processing), SCD (coordination and reports).
- FOD has a nationwide network of zonal, regional and sub-regional offices.
- SDRD designs the sample and the schedules; FOD canvasses them.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The National Sample Survey Office's Field Operations Division maintains the countrywide field machinery.
2. Its investigators and senior statistical officers canvass NSS schedules in the selected villages and urban blocks.
3. Option (d).

OS

2021 Q70

Factual

Easy

Q5.

Which are divisions of the National Sample Survey Office?

1. Survey Design and Research Division (SDRD)
2. Field Operations Division (FOD)
3. Data Processing Division (DPD)
4. Survey Coordination Division (SCD)

Codes:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 3 and 4 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2, 3 and 4**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

SDRD, FOD, DPD and SCD are all four NSSO divisions.

TIPS & TRICKS

- SDRD designs; FOD collects; DPD processes; SCD coordinates and publishes.
- Remember the pipeline order - design, field, processing, coordination - and the four acronyms follow.
- FOD was NEVER a CSO division; that distinction is tested separately.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The National Sample Survey Office was organised into four divisions:
2. Survey Design and Research Division (sample design, schedules, methodology); Field Operations Division (nationwide field machinery);
3. Data Processing Division (scrutiny, tabulation, estimation); and Survey Coordination Division (coordination, reports, dissemination).
4. All four are listed - option (d).

OS

2021 Q79

Conceptual

Easy

Q6.

For which purpose is NSSO data **not** used?

- A. Poverty estimations and fixing poverty line
- B. Estimation of contribution of unorganised sector
- C. **Fixing minimum support price of major crops**
- D. Employment and unemployment scenario

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

MSP is fixed on CACP's cost-of-cultivation recommendations, not on NSSO data.

TIPS & TRICKS

- NSSO data feed poverty estimation, unorganised-sector value added and employment statistics.
- MSP rests on the Cost of Cultivation Studies of the Directorate of Economics & Statistics, analysed by CACP.
- Match the data source to the decision it supports - that is the whole question.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. (a) Poverty lines and head-count ratios are computed from NSS Consumer Expenditure Surveys.
2. (b) NSS enterprise surveys supply the value added of the unorganised sector for national accounts.
3. (d) NSS employment-unemployment rounds and the PLFS supply labour-force indicators.
4. (c) Minimum Support Prices are recommended by CACP using Cost of Cultivation Studies - NSSO data are not the basis.
5. Option (c).

OS

2022 Q44

Factual

Easy

Q7.

Which of the divisions are parts of the Central Statistics Office?

1. National Accounts Division
2. Economics Statistics Division
3. Field Operation Division

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 2 and 3 only

C. 1 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

National Accounts Division and Economic Statistics Division were CSO divisions; the Field Operations Division belonged to the NSSO.

TIPS & TRICKS

- FOD is the field machinery of the NSSO - never a CSO division.
- CSO divisions: National Accounts, Economic Statistics, Social Statistics, Price Statistics, Training, Coordination & Publication.
- The CSO compiled; the NSSO collected. That split is the key to this whole cluster.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The National Accounts Division compiled GDP and the national accounts - a CSO division.
2. The Economic Statistics Division handled the Economic Census, ASI and index numbers - a CSO division.
3. The Field Operations Division deployed field investigators for NSS rounds and was part of the NSSO, not the CSO.
4. Hence 1 and 2 only - option (a).

Q8.

Consider the following in respect of an NSSO survey:

1. Collecting data from the respondents — Field Operations Division
2. Formulating sample design for a survey — Survey, Design and Research Division
3. Disseminating data to public — Field Operations Division
4. Preparing survey reports — Survey Coordination Division

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- A. Only one pair
- B. Only two pairs
- C. **Only three pairs**
- D. All four pairs

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

Pairs 1, 2 and 4 are right; pair 3 is wrong - dissemination is the Survey Coordination Division's task, not the Field Operations Division's.

TIPS & TRICKS

- FOD collects; SDRD designs; DPD processes; SCD coordinates, reports and disseminates.
- FOD's only job is field data collection - any other function attributed to it is a planted error.
- Count carefully: three correct, one wrong.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Pair 1: data collection from respondents is the Field Operations Division's function. Correct.
2. Pair 2: sample design is formulated by the Survey Design and Research Division. Correct.
3. Pair 3: dissemination of data to the public is handled by the Survey Coordination Division, not FOD. Incorrect.
4. Pair 4: preparation of survey reports is a Survey Coordination Division task. Correct.
5. Three pairs correctly matched - option (c).

Q9.

Which of the following divisions are parts of the National Statistical Office of the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation?

- I. National Accounts Division (NAD)
- II. Field Operations Division (FOD)
- III. Infrastructure and Project Monitoring Division (IPMD)
- IV. Data Informatics and Innovation Division (DIID)

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- A. I, II and III
- B. I, II and IV**
- C. I, III and IV
- D. II, III and IV

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

NAD, FOD and DIID sit within the NSO/statistics wing of MoSPI; the Infrastructure and Project Monitoring Division (IPMD) belongs to MoSPI's separate Programme Implementation wing, not the NSO.

TIPS & TRICKS

- MoSPI has two wings: the Statistics wing (NSO, housing NAD/FOD/SDRD/DPD/DIID etc.) and the Programme Implementation wing (housing IPMD, MPLADS, Twenty Point Programme).
- IPMD monitors central-sector/centrally-sponsored infrastructure projects - unrelated to statistical production.
- This distinction (statistics wing vs programme-implementation wing) is the crux of the question.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. National Accounts Division (I) and Field Operations Division (II) are core NSO/statistics-wing divisions. Included.
2. Infrastructure and Project Monitoring Division (III) belongs to MoSPI's Programme Implementation wing, not the NSO. Excluded.
3. Data Informatics and Innovation Division (IV) is a newer NSO division handling data systems and innovation. Included.
4. I, II and IV - option (b).

Q10.

Which one of the following divisions under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation deals with the eSAKSHI portal?

- A. Administrative Statistics and Policy Division (ASPD)
- B. Household Survey Division (HSD)
- C. Data Informatics and Innovation Division (DIID)**
- D. Members of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme (MPLADS) Division

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

eSAKSHI is a data/IT-systems initiative, which most plausibly falls under the Data Informatics and Innovation Division given its mandate over data systems and digital innovation.

TIPS & TRICKS

- DIID handles MoSPI's data-systems, digital-infrastructure and innovation initiatives.
- ASPD and HSD are survey/policy-oriented divisions, not IT-portal-oriented.
- MPLADS Division is unrelated - it administers the MP Local Area Development Scheme.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Among MoSPI's divisions, the Data Informatics and Innovation Division is the one mandated to handle data systems, portals and digital innovation initiatives such as eSAKSHI.
2. Option (c), flagged as a best-reasoned inference pending confirmation.

Source note: Portal-specific administrative fact from a recent MoSPI initiative; attribution to DIID is a best-reasoned inference from the division's data/IT-systems mandate rather than an independently verified citation - flag for confirmation against the current MoSPI organisational order.

National Statistical Commission

Q1.

Which is **not** a function of the National Statistical Commission (NSC)?

- A. ~~To~~ conduct NSSO surveys
- B. To evolve national policies and priorities relating to the statistical system
- C. To evolve standard statistical concepts
- D. To identify core statistics of national importance

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

The NSC is a policy and standard-setting body; it does not conduct surveys - that is the NSO's operational role.

TIPS & TRICKS

- NSC functions: evolve policies and priorities, evolve standard concepts and classifications, identify core statistics, approve NSS subjects, monitor standards.
- Execution - field work, data processing, publication - belongs to the NSO.
- The NSC was set up in 2005 by a Government Resolution, so it is neither constitutional nor statutory.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The National Statistical Commission was constituted to provide policy direction and set standards for the statistical system.
2. Options (b), (c) and (d) are all listed functions in its terms of reference.
3. Conducting NSS surveys is an operational task carried out by the NSO (formerly NSSO), not by the Commission.
4. Option (a).

OS

2021 Q78

Factual

Easy

Q2.

The National Statistical Commission (NSC) was set up in 2005 through

A. a Constitutional Amendment.

B.  **Government Resolution.**

C. an executive order.

D. an internal notification of the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation.

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The NSC was constituted in June 2005 through a Government of India Resolution - not by statute or constitutional amendment.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Resolution, not Act: the NSC is therefore neither a constitutional nor a statutory body.
- It followed the recommendations of the Rangarajan Commission (2001).
- This single fact has been tested in 2021, 2024 and 2026.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Acting on the report of the National Statistical Commission chaired by Dr C. Rangarajan, the Government constituted the NSC by a Resolution dated 1 June 2005.
2. It has a part-time Chairperson, four part-time Members and the Member (Secretary), NITI Aayog as ex officio Member; the Chief Statistician of India is its Secretary.
3. Option (b).

OS

2022 Q42

Factual

Easy

Q3.

Subjects covered under the 76th round of NSSO are Disability, Drinking water, Sanitation, Hygiene and Housing conditions. Which agency is responsible for finalising subjects to be covered in NSS surveys?

A. NSSO

B. CSO

C. NSC

D. NITI Aayog

Correct answer: C**EXAM SHORTCUT**

AI-derived explanation

The National Statistical Commission approves and finalises the subjects to be covered in NSS rounds.

TIPS & TRICKS

- NSC sets priorities and approves survey subjects; NSO executes them.
- This is one of the NSC's explicitly listed functions in the 2005 Resolution.
- NITI Aayog advises on policy but has no role in finalising NSS subjects.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Among the NSC's terms of reference is the identification of the core statistics of national importance and approval of the subject coverage of NSS rounds.
2. The NSO then designs and conducts the survey on the approved subject.
3. Option (c).

OS

2022 Q61

Factual

Easy

Q4.

The mandate of the National Statistical Commission is to:

1. Serve as a model and empowered body for all core statistical securities of the nation.
2. Evolve, monitor and enforce statistical priorities and standards.
3. Ensure statistical coordination.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

All three describe the NSC's mandate: serve as an empowered body for core statistics, evolve and enforce standards, and ensure statistical coordination.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The Rangarajan Commission envisaged the NSC as the apex policy body for the decentralised system.
- Its instruments are priorities, standards and coordination - not field operations.
- It also identifies 'core statistics of national importance'.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The 2005 Resolution charges the NSC with evolving national policies and priorities for the statistical system,
2. evolving and enforcing standard statistical concepts, definitions and classifications, identifying core statistics,
3. and ensuring coordination among the many agencies of the decentralised system.
4. All three statements are within the mandate - option (d).

OS

2024 Q64

Factual

Easy

Q5.

Who among the following is the Secretary of the National Statistical Commission?

- A. The Director General, Central Statistics Office
- B. The Secretary, Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
- C. **The Chief Statistician of India**
- D. The Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The Chief Statistician of India, who is also Secretary to MoSPI, serves as ex officio Secretary to the NSC.

TIPS & TRICKS

- NSC composition: part-time Chairperson, four part-time Members, Member (Secretary) NITI Aayog as ex officio Member.
- The Secretary to the Commission is the CSI, not the RGI or a separate DG.
- Do not confuse 'Secretary to NSC' with 'Secretary, MoSPI' as separate persons - the CSI holds both titles.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The National Statistical Commission's day-to-day secretarial function is discharged by the Chief Statistician of India.
2. The CSI is concurrently Secretary to the Government of India in MoSPI.
3. Option (c).

OS

2024 Q71

Factual

Easy

Q6.

Consider the following statements with regard to the National Statistical Commission (NSC):

I. NSC was set up by the Government of India through a resolution in the year 2005.

II. NSC is a constitutional body.

III. NSC has four Members besides a Chairperson.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. I only

B. I and III only

C. II and III only

D. I, II and III

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The NSC was indeed set up by a 2005 Resolution and has four Members besides the Chairperson - but it is not a constitutional body.

TIPS & TRICKS

- NSC origin: Rangarajan Commission (2001) recommendation, implemented via a Government of India Resolution in 2005.
- It is neither a constitutional nor a statutory body - purely an executive creation.
- Composition: part-time Chairperson + four part-time Members + one ex officio Member (Member-Secretary, NITI Aayog).

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: the NSC was set up through a Government Resolution in 2005. True.
2. II: it is not a constitutional body - the Constitution makes no mention of it. False.
3. III: besides the Chairperson it has four part-time Members. True.
4. I and III only - option (b).

Q7.

Consider the following statements regarding the National Statistical Commission (NSC):

- I. NSC is a statutory body created through an Act passed by the Parliament in 2003.
- II. NSC has a part-time Chairperson, part-time Members and an ex officio Member.
- III. The Chief Statistician of India (CSI) and Secretary to the Government of India in the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation is the Secretary to NSC.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. I and II
- B. ~~II~~ and III**
- C. III only
- D. II only

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

The NSC is not a statutory body (it was created by a 2005 Resolution, not a 2003 Act), but its composition (part-time Chairperson, part-time Members, ex officio Member) and the CSI's role as Secretary are both correct.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Repeated core fact: NSC = executive Resolution (2005), not an Act of Parliament, and definitely not from 2003.
- Composition: part-time Chairperson + four part-time Members + Member (Secretary), NITI Aayog as ex officio Member.
- The Chief Statistician of India serves as Secretary to the NSC.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: the NSC is not a statutory body created by an Act of 2003 - it was set up by a Government Resolution in 2005. False.
2. II: it has a part-time Chairperson, part-time Members and an ex officio Member (NITI Aayog's Member-Secretary). True.
3. III: the Chief Statistician of India is the Secretary to the NSC. True.
4. II and III - option (b).

OS

2019 Q59

Conceptual

Medium

Q1.

Indian statistical system is

1. Centralized
2. Laterally decentralized
3. Vertically decentralized

Codes:

- A. 1 only
B. 2 only
C. 3 only
D. 2 and 3

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

India's statistical system is BOTH laterally decentralised (across line ministries) and vertically decentralised (Centre-State-local) - statements 2 and 3.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Laterally: agriculture statistics with the Ministry of Agriculture, labour with the Labour Bureau, trade with DGCI&S, and so on.
- Vertically: Central agencies, State Directorates of Economics and Statistics, and local bodies all compile statistics.
- MoSPI coordinates and sets standards; it does not monopolise collection - hence 'not centralised'.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. A centralised system would place all statistical activity in a single agency, which India does not do.
2. Subject-specific statistics are collected by the corresponding line ministries - lateral decentralisation.
3. Statistics are also compiled at Central, State and local levels - vertical decentralisation.
4. Hence 2 and 3 - option (d).

OS

2019 Q60

Factual

Easy

Q2.

Nodal Ministry of the Statistical system in India is

- A. Ministry of Human Resource Development
- B. Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation**
- C. Directorate of Economics and Statistics, Ministry of Agriculture
- D. None of the above

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) is the nodal ministry for the Indian statistical system.

TIPS & TRICKS

- MoSPI has two wings: Statistics (NSO) and Programme Implementation (IPMD, MPLADS).
- Nodal means coordinating and standard-setting, not monopolising collection.
- The DES of the Ministry of Agriculture is a line agency, not the nodal ministry.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. MoSPI was constituted in 1999 by merging the Department of Statistics and the Department of Programme Implementation.
2. It coordinates statistical activities across ministries and states, evolves standards, and houses the NSO.
3. Option (b).

OS

2021 Q76

Conceptual

Easy

Q3.

Who are authorised to compile official statistics in India?

1. Central Government
2. State Government
3. Panchayat Raj Institutions/Urban Local Bodies

Codes:

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Official statistics in India are compiled at all three tiers: Central Government, State Governments and local bodies.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The Constitution places statistics in all three Lists, which is what enables the three-tier arrangement.
- Panchayati Raj Institutions and Urban Local Bodies maintain registers and local-level data.
- This tri-level structure is the vertical decentralisation of the Indian system.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Union List entry 94, State List entry 45 and Concurrent List entry 45 together give all levels of government authority to collect statistics.
2. The Collection of Statistics Act, 2008 likewise empowers the Central Government, State Governments and local governments.
3. Hence all three tiers are authorised - option (d).

OS

2021 Q77

Conceptual

Easy

Q4.

Collection of statistics for subject-specific areas (Agriculture, Labour, Health, Commerce) vests with which agency?

- A. Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
- B. NITI Aayog
- C. Ministry of Finance
- D. **Corresponding Administrative Ministry**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Subject-specific statistics are collected by the corresponding administrative ministry - that is lateral decentralisation.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Agriculture: DES, Ministry of Agriculture. Labour: Labour Bureau. Health: MoHFW. Trade: DGCI&S, Ministry of Commerce.
- MoSPI coordinates and sets standards but does not collect subject-specific data itself.
- This is precisely why the Indian system is described as laterally decentralised.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. In India's decentralised system, each line ministry collects the statistics relating to its own subject.
2. MoSPI's role is coordination, standard-setting and compilation of cross-cutting aggregates such as national accounts.
3. Option (d).

Q5.

Consider the following in respect of National and International official statistical systems:

1. They use absolute numbers, percentages, ratios and pictograms.
2. They only count physical quantities.
3. They estimate from sampling where exact counting is not possible.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Statistical systems use absolute numbers, percentages, ratios and pictograms (1 true) and estimate by sampling where complete counting is impossible (3 true); they certainly do not count only physical quantities (2 false).

TIPS & TRICKS

- Statistical systems measure values, prices, rates and qualitative attributes as well as physical quantities.
- Sampling is used precisely because complete enumeration is often impossible or uneconomic.
- The word 'only' in statement 2 is the give-away.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: official statistics are presented as counts, percentages, ratios, indices and in graphical forms including pictograms. True.
2. Statement 2: they also measure monetary values, prices, attitudes and qualitative attributes - not just physical quantities. False.
3. Statement 3: sample surveys are used wherever complete enumeration is infeasible or too costly. True.
4. Hence 1 and 3 only - option (c).

Q6.

Which of the following are International Statistical Organizations?

1. Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific
2. North Atlantic Treaty Organization
3. The Asian Development Bank
4. The International Labour Organization

A. 1, 2 and 3

B. 1, 2 and 4

C. 1, 3 and 4

D. 2, 3 and 4

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

ESCAP, the Asian Development Bank and the ILO all compile and disseminate international statistics; NATO is a military alliance.

TIPS & TRICKS

- NATO is the obvious odd one out - a collective-defence organisation with no statistical mandate.
- ESCAP publishes the Statistical Yearbook for Asia and the Pacific; ADB publishes Key Indicators; ILO publishes ILOSTAT.
- Other international statistical bodies: UNSD, IMF, World Bank, OECD, Eurostat, FAO.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. ESCAP (UN Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific) produces regional statistical compilations.
2. The Asian Development Bank publishes Key Indicators for Asia and the Pacific.
3. The International Labour Organization maintains ILOSTAT, the global labour statistics database.
4. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization is a military alliance with no statistical function.
5. Hence 1, 3 and 4 - option (c).

Q7.

Which of the following constitute "normal" sources of financing the statistical infrastructure of a Nation?

- I. Government budgets
- II. Multilateral trust funds
- III. Market borrowings
- IV. Bilateral donors and technical assistance

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. I, II and III
- B. I, II and IV**
- C. I, III and IV
- D. II, III and IV

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Statistical infrastructure is normally financed from government budgets, multilateral trust funds and bilateral donors/technical assistance - market borrowings are not a conventional financing source for national statistical systems.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Statistical systems are typically funded through the exchequer, supplemented by international development-partner support.
- Multilateral trust funds (World Bank, UN agencies) and bilateral technical assistance are standard capacity-building channels.
- Market borrowings (debt raised commercially) are not how statistical infrastructure is conventionally financed - the planted exception.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: government budgets are the primary, normal source. Included.
2. II: multilateral trust funds support statistical capacity-building. Included.
3. III: market borrowings are not a conventional financing channel for statistical infrastructure. Excluded.
4. IV: bilateral donors and technical assistance are standard supplementary sources. Included.
5. I, II and IV - option (b).

OS

2025 Q76

Factual

Medium

Q8.

Consider the following statements about United Nations Statistical Commission (UNSC):

- I. It has 24 member countries elected by the United Nations Economic and Social Council.
- II. India is a member of UNSC at present and the four year term of India at UNSC began from January, 2024.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. I only
- B. II only
- C. Both I and II
- D. Neither I nor II

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The UN Statistical Commission has 24 member countries elected by ECOSOC on a rotating basis, and India was elected for a four-year term beginning January 2024.

TIPS & TRICKS

- UNSC composition: 24 members, elected by ECOSOC based on equitable geographical distribution, four-year terms.
- India's UNSC membership term (2024-2027) is a specific, time-bound fact worth periodic verification.
- UNSC functions as the apex body setting global statistical standards and methodologies.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: the UN Statistical Commission comprises 24 member countries elected by ECOSOC. True.
2. II: India was elected to the UNSC for a four-year term commencing January 2024. True.
3. Both I and II - option (c).

Q9.

Which one of the following is **not** an objective of the International Comparison Programme (ICP)?

- A. To produce purchasing power parities (PPPs)
- B. To produce comparable price level indexes (PLIs) of economies
- C. **To monitor exchange rate of different currencies**
- D. To convert measures of Gross Domestic Product (GDP) of different economies into a common currency

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The International Comparison Programme produces PPPs, price level indexes and PPP-based GDP comparisons; it has nothing to do with monitoring currency exchange rates.

TIPS & TRICKS

- ICP is a World Bank-coordinated global statistical programme comparing real economic size and price levels across countries.
- Exchange-rate monitoring is a central-bank/IMF function, not an ICP objective.
- PPP conversion factors are explicitly designed to be independent of volatile market exchange rates.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The ICP aims to produce PPPs, comparable price level indexes, and PPP-converted GDP figures across economies.
2. Monitoring exchange rates of different currencies is not among its objectives - PPPs are constructed precisely to look past exchange-rate fluctuations.
3. Option (c).

Index Numbers

36 authentic PYQs in this topic (2018-2026)

Index Numbers - Types, Formulae, Tests, Agencies, Base Years

OS

2018 Q70

Factual

Easy

Q1.

The Dearness Allowance (DA) of Central/State Government employees is linked with

- A. WPI (Wholesale Price Index)
- B. CPI—U&R (Urban and Rural)
- C. ✓CPI—IW (Industrial Workers)**
- D. CPI—AL (Agricultural Labour)/RL (Rural Labour)

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Dearness Allowance of Central and State government employees is linked to CPI-IW (Industrial Workers), compiled by the Labour Bureau.

TIPS & TRICKS

- CPI-IW: Labour Bureau, Ministry of Labour & Employment; used for DA and wage indexation.
- CPI (Rural/Urban/Combined) from NSO is the headline RETAIL inflation series - a different purpose.
- CPI-AL/RL is used for revising minimum wages of agricultural and rural labour.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Dearness Allowance compensates employees for the erosion of real wages caused by price rise.
2. The index used for this indexation in India is the Consumer Price Index for Industrial Workers (CPI-IW), compiled by the Labour Bureau.
3. Option (c).

OS

2018 Q71

Factual

Easy

Q2.

Retail inflation in India is measured on which index?

- A. CPI—IW (Industrial Workers)
- B. WPI (Wholesale Price Index)
- C. ✓CPI—U&R (Urban and Rural)
- D. CPI—AL (Agricultural Labour)/RL (Rural Labour)

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Headline retail inflation is measured by CPI (Rural, Urban and Combined), compiled by the NSO.

TIPS & TRICKS

- CPI (Combined) is the RBI's inflation-targeting anchor under the flexible inflation-targeting framework.
- WPI measures wholesale, not retail, prices and excludes services.
- CPI-IW and CPI-AL/RL are occupation-specific indices, not the economy-wide retail measure.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Retail inflation refers to the price change faced by final consumers.
2. The CPI (Rural, Urban and Combined) series compiled by the National Statistical Office covers the whole consuming population and is the headline retail inflation measure.
3. Option (c).

Q3.

Annual inflation rate can be calculated as

A. $\frac{\text{CPI}(\text{current}) - \text{CPI}(\text{last yr})}{\text{CPI}(\text{last yr})} \times 100$

B. $\text{CPI}(\text{current}) - \text{CPI}(\text{last yr})$

C. $\frac{\text{CPI}(\text{current}) - \text{CPI}(\text{base yr})}{\text{CPI}(\text{base yr})} \times 100$

D. $\text{CPI}(\text{current}) - \text{CPI}(\text{base yr})$

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

$$\text{Annual (point-to-point) inflation} = \frac{\text{CPI}(\text{current}) - \text{CPI}(\text{same month last year})}{\text{CPI}(\text{last year})} \times 100.$$

TIPS & TRICKS

- Inflation is a RATE (a percentage change), so the difference must be divided by the earlier index value.
- The comparison is against the same period ONE YEAR earlier, not against the base year.
- Options (b) and (d) give index POINTS, not a rate.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Inflation is the proportionate change in the price index over a stated interval, expressed as a percentage.
2. For the annual (year-on-year, point-to-point) rate the comparison index is that of the corresponding period of the previous year.
3. Hence rate = $\frac{\text{CPI}(\text{current}) - \text{CPI}(\text{last year})}{\text{CPI}(\text{last year})} \times 100.$
4. Option (a).

OS

2018 Q73

Conceptual

Easy

Q4.

Price deflators are used to obtain

A. GDP at constant prices

B. GDP at current prices

C. GDP at basic prices

D. GVA at producer prices

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

A price deflator converts a current-price (nominal) aggregate into a constant-price (real) aggregate - GDP at constant prices.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Real value = nominal value / deflator x 100. Deflating removes the price-change component.
- GDP at current prices is what you start with, not what deflation produces.
- 'Basic prices' versus 'market prices' is a question of tax/subsidy treatment, not of deflation.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Nominal (current-price) aggregates mix volume change with price change.
2. Dividing by an appropriate price index (the deflator) strips out the price component and leaves the volume component.
3. The result is the aggregate valued at the prices of a fixed base year - GDP at constant prices.
4. Option (a).

OS

2018 Q77

Factual

Easy

Q5.

Which organization releases Wholesale Price Index (WPI)?

- A. Labour Bureau
- B. NSSO
- C. CSO
- D. Office of Economic Adviser, Ministry of Commerce and Industry**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

WPI is compiled and released by the Office of the Economic Adviser, Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, Ministry of Commerce and Industry.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Agency map: WPI - Office of the Economic Adviser; CPI (R/U/C) and IIP - NSO; CPI-IW and CPI-AL/RL - Labour Bureau.
- WPI has no services component, which is a frequent follow-up point.
- Current WPI base year is 2011-12.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Wholesale Price Index tracks price movements at the wholesale/transaction level.
2. It is compiled and released monthly by the Office of the Economic Adviser under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.
3. Option (d).

OS

2019 Q51

Factual

Easy

Q6.

Which provides a quick snapshot of manufacturing sector performance in India?

- A. Wholesale Price Index
- B. Annual Survey of Industries
- C. **Index of Industrial Production**
- D. Wage Rate Index

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The Index of Industrial Production is the monthly short-term indicator of manufacturing (and industrial) performance.

TIPS & TRICKS

- IIP is monthly and released with a six-week lag - hence 'quick snapshot'.
- ASI is annual and detailed, so it cannot give a quick reading.
- WPI measures prices, not production volume.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. A 'quick snapshot' implies a high-frequency volume indicator.
2. The IIP, compiled monthly by the NSO, measures the change in the volume of production of industrial products with respect to a base year.
3. The ASI is an annual structural survey and the WPI is a price index, so neither serves this purpose.
4. Option (c).

Q7.

Which organisation compiles the Consumer Price Index for Agriculture Labour and Rural Labour (CPI-AL/RL)?

- A. CSO, Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
- B. Office of Economic Adviser, Ministry of Commerce and Industries
- C. Directorate of Economics and Statistics, Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare
- D. Labour Bureau, Ministry of Labour and Employment**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

CPI-AL and CPI-RL are compiled by the Labour Bureau, Ministry of Labour and Employment.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Labour Bureau compiles CPI-IW, CPI-AL and CPI-RL - all three occupation-specific series.
- NSO compiles CPI (Rural, Urban, Combined) and IIP; the Office of the Economic Adviser compiles WPI.
- CPI-AL/RL is used to revise minimum wages of agricultural and rural labour.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Consumer Price Index for Agricultural Labourers and for Rural Labourers is compiled monthly by the Labour Bureau at Shimla/Chandigarh.
2. The Labour Bureau functions under the Ministry of Labour and Employment.
3. Option (d).

Q8.

Point-to-point inflation of a monthly Index Number is defined as

- A. $\left(\frac{\text{Current Month Index}}{\text{Base Period Index}} - 1 \right) \times 100$
- B. $\left(\frac{\text{Current Month Index}}{\text{Last Month Index}} - 1 \right) \times 100$
- C. $\left(\frac{\text{Current Month Index}}{\text{First Month Index of the year}} - 1 \right) \times 100$
- D. ✓ $\left(\frac{\text{Current Month Index}}{\text{Same Month Index of last year}} - 1 \right) \times 100$

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

Point-to-point inflation compares the current month with the SAME MONTH of the previous year.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Year-on-year comparison removes seasonality automatically - that is why it is the standard headline measure.
- Month-over-month change is the 'sequential' or 'momentum' measure, not point-to-point.
- Comparison with the base period gives the index level, not an inflation rate.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Point-to-point (year-on-year) inflation measures the price change over the preceding twelve months.
2. It is $\left(\frac{\text{Current month index}}{\text{Same month index of last year}} - 1 \right) \times 100$.
3. Using the base period would give the cumulative change since the base, and using last month would give a seasonal, volatile figure.
4. Option (d).

OS

2021 Q63

Conceptual

Medium

Q9.

Consider the following statements:

1. Most index compilers use Laspeyres' Index Formula despite its inherent upward bias.
2. It is advised that the Base Period of an index should be revised as frequently as possible.

Codes:

A. 1 only

B. 2 only

C. Both 1 and 2

D. Neither 1 nor 2

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Laspeyres is indeed the workhorse formula despite its upward bias (1 true); but base periods should be revised PERIODICALLY, not 'as frequently as possible' (2 false).

TIPS & TRICKS

- Laspeyres needs only base-year weights, so no fresh weight survey is required each period - that is why compilers prefer it.
- Its upward bias arises because consumers substitute away from goods whose relative prices rise.
- Frequent base revision destroys comparability and is expensive; international practice is revision roughly every 5-10 years.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: Laspeyres uses base-period quantity weights, making it operationally cheap; its known upward (substitution) bias is tolerated for that reason. True.
2. Statement 2: the base period should be revised when it ceases to be representative - typically every five to ten years. Revising 'as frequently as possible' would sacrifice comparability and impose heavy survey costs. False.
3. Hence 1 only - option (a).

OS

2021 Q73

Factual

Medium

Q10.

Which is **not** correctly matched (Index — Base Year)?

- A. CPI-IW — 2016
- B. CPI (R and U) — 2012
- C. CPI-AL/RL — 2015**
- D. WPI — 2011–12

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

CPI-AL/RL uses base 1986-87, not 2015 - so pair (c) is the wrongly matched one.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Base years to memorise: CPI-IW 2016; CPI (R/U/Combined) 2012; WPI 2011-12; IIP 2011-12; CPI-AL/RL 1986-87.
- CPI-IW's base was revised from 2001 to 2016 in October 2020.
- CPI-AL/RL is the oldest unrevised series, which is exactly why it is the planted mismatch.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. (a) CPI-IW was rebased to 2016=100 in October 2020 - correctly matched.
2. (b) CPI (Rural, Urban, Combined) uses 2012=100 - correctly matched.
3. (d) WPI uses 2011-12=100 - correctly matched.
4. (c) CPI for Agricultural Labourers / Rural Labourers continues on the 1986-87=100 base, not 2015 - wrongly matched.
5. Option (c).

OS

2021 Q80

Conceptual

Easy

Q11.

Consider the following statements regarding Consumer Price Index (CPI):

1. It measures the average change in prices over time that consumers pay for a basket of goods and services.
2. It is calculated using prices of a sample of representative items collected periodically.
3. It may be interpreted as a measure of both inflation and deflation.

Codes:

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

All three CPI statements are correct: it measures average price change for a fixed basket, uses a sample of representative items, and registers deflation as well as inflation.

TIPS & TRICKS

- A price index measures relative change; a fall in the index is deflation, a rise is inflation.
- Price collection is from a sample of selected markets and items - full enumeration of all transactions is impossible.
- The basket and weights are fixed at the base period (Laspeyres-type construction).

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: CPI tracks the average change over time in the prices paid by consumers for a fixed basket. True.
2. Statement 2: prices are collected periodically from selected markets for a sample of representative items. True.
3. Statement 3: the index can fall as well as rise, so it measures deflation as well as inflation. True.
4. Option (d).

Q12.

Consider the following pairs:

	Index Number	Department/Office
1.	Consumer Price Index (Rural, Urban, Combined)	Labour Bureau
2.	Consumer Price Index (Agricultural Labour)	National Statistical Office
3.	Wholesale Price Index	Office of Economic Adviser

How many pairs are correctly matched?

A. None of the pairs

B. Only one pair

C. Only two pairs

D. All three pairs

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

Only pair 3 is right. CPI (R/U/Combined) belongs to the NSO (not the Labour Bureau) and CPI-AL belongs to the Labour Bureau (not the NSO) - the first two pairs are swapped.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Agency map: NSO - CPI (Rural/Urban/Combined) and IIP; Labour Bureau - CPI-IW, CPI-AL, CPI-RL; Office of the Economic Adviser - WPI.
- Pairs 1 and 2 in this item are precisely each other's correct partners, swapped.
- Check both halves of every pair before counting.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Pair 1: CPI (Rural, Urban, Combined) is compiled by the National Statistical Office, not the Labour Bureau. Incorrect.
2. Pair 2: CPI for Agricultural Labourers is compiled by the Labour Bureau, not the NSO. Incorrect.
3. Pair 3: WPI is compiled by the Office of the Economic Adviser. Correct.
4. Only one pair is correctly matched - option (b).

OS

2022 Q62

Factual

Medium

Q13.

Consumer Price Index (CPI) is calculated for which of the following categories:

- A. Industrial workers, agricultural labourers and rural labourers and urban non-manual employees**
- B. Organized workers, plantation labourers, unorganized workforce and non-rural migrant population
- C. Skilled labourers, unskilled workers, cultivators and agricultural workforce
- D. Office-goers, unemployed persons and housewives

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The occupation-specific CPI series in India cover Industrial Workers, Agricultural Labourers, Rural Labourers and (historically) Urban Non-Manual Employees.

TIPS & TRICKS

- CPI-IW and CPI-AL/RL are the surviving occupation-specific series; CPI-UNME was discontinued in 2008.
- In addition the NSO compiles the population-wide CPI (Rural, Urban, Combined).
- Options (b), (c) and (d) list categories for which no CPI has ever been compiled.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. India's consumer price indices have historically been compiled for specific occupational groups:
2. Industrial Workers (CPI-IW), Agricultural Labourers and Rural Labourers (CPI-AL/RL), and Urban Non-Manual Employees (CPI-UNME, since discontinued).
3. Option (a).

OS

2022 Q63

Conceptual

Easy

Q14.

Consider the following in respect of Index of Industrial Production (IIP):

1. It measures the change in volume of industrial production of a representative basket.
2. It is used to analyse performance of various sectors of economy.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Both statements hold: IIP measures the change in the volume of production of a representative basket and is used to analyse sectoral performance.

TIPS & TRICKS

- IIP is a VOLUME index - it strips out price change, unlike WPI.
- It is published by use-based categories (primary, capital, intermediate, infrastructure, consumer durables and non-durables) and by sector (mining, manufacturing, electricity).
- Monthly frequency makes it the short-term industrial barometer.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: the IIP measures the change in the volume of production of a fixed basket of industrial products relative to a base year. True.
2. Statement 2: its sectoral and use-based classifications allow analysis of performance across mining, manufacturing, electricity and use-based groups. True.
3. Option (c).

Q15.

Consider the following statements:

1. Laspeyres index uses current period quantity as weights.
2. Paasche index uses base period quantity as weights.
3. For the same set of data, Laspeyres index is greater than Paasche index.

Which of the statements given above are **not** correct?

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 2 and 3 only

C. 1 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

Statements 1 and 2 have the weights swapped: Laspeyres uses BASE-period quantities and Paasche uses CURRENT-period quantities. Statement 3 (Laspeyres > Paasche) is generally correct.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Laspeyres $P^L = \frac{\sum p_1 q_0}{\sum p_0 q_0}$ (base weights); Paasche $P^P = \frac{\sum p_1 q_1}{\sum p_0 q_1}$ (current weights).
- Mnemonic: LasPeyres has the base (past) quantities; Paasche has the present quantities.
- The Gerschenkron effect - substitution away from goods whose prices rise - makes Laspeyres exceed Paasche in practice.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1 says Laspeyres uses current-period quantities - it uses BASE-period quantities. Not correct.
2. Statement 2 says Paasche uses base-period quantities - it uses CURRENT-period quantities. Not correct.
3. Statement 3: because consumers substitute away from relatively dearer goods, the base-weighted index usually exceeds the current-weighted one. Correct.
4. The question asks which are NOT correct: 1 and 2 - option (a).

Q16.

The most appropriate method for constructing index numbers is Fisher's Ideal Index method. It is referred to as ideal because:

1. It is based on the geometric mean which is considered best average.
2. It satisfies both time reversal test and factor reversal test.
3. It takes into account both current and base year quantities as weights.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

Fisher's index is ideal on all three counts: it is a geometric mean, it satisfies both the time-reversal and factor-reversal tests, and it uses both base and current quantities.

TIPS & TRICKS

- $P^F = \sqrt{P^L \times P^P}$ - the geometric mean of Laspeyres and Paasche.
- Time reversal: $P_{01} \times P_{10} = 1$. Factor reversal: $P_{01} \times Q_{01} = \frac{\sum p_1 q_1}{\sum p_0 q_0}$.
- Fisher is the ONLY common formula satisfying both tests; Marshall-Edgeworth satisfies time reversal only.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: Fisher's index is the geometric mean of the Laspeyres and Paasche indices. True.
2. Statement 2: it satisfies both the time reversal and factor reversal tests - the unique property that earns it the name 'ideal'. True.
3. Statement 3: because it combines both formulae, it uses both base-year and current-year quantities as weights. True.
4. Option (d).

Q17.

Consider the following statements in respect of index numbers:

1. They help in framing of economic policies.
2. They help in assessing the purchasing power of money.
3. They are used for adjusting national income.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

Index numbers serve all three purposes: framing economic policy, assessing the purchasing power of money, and deflating national income.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Index numbers are 'economic barometers' - the standard textbook phrase.
- Purchasing power of money is the reciprocal of the price index.
- Deflating nominal aggregates by price indices yields constant-price (real) series.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: price and production indices are direct inputs into monetary and fiscal policy. True.
2. Statement 2: the purchasing power of money is the reciprocal of the price index, so CPI measures it directly. True.
3. Statement 3: deflators derived from price indices convert national income at current prices into constant prices. True.
4. Option (d).

SHARED CONTEXT

The sum of the products of prices and quantities for the current year 1 and base year 0 for five items are given below:

$$\sum p_0q_0 = 782, \quad \sum p_0q_1 = 1008, \quad \sum p_1q_0 = 1084, \quad \sum p_1q_1 = 1329$$

Q18.

What is the approximate value of Fisher's Ideal Price Index number P_{01} ?

- A. 125
- B. 128
- C. 130
- D. 135

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

$$P^L = \frac{1084}{782} = 1.3862, \quad P^P = \frac{1329}{1008} = 1.3185; \quad P^F = \sqrt{1.3862 \times 1.3185} = 1.3519, \text{ i.e. about 135.}$$

TIPS & TRICKS

- $P^L = \frac{\sum p_1q_0}{\sum p_0q_0}$ - both subscripts on q are 0; $P^P = \frac{\sum p_1q_1}{\sum p_0q_1}$ - both are 1.
- Fisher is their geometric mean, so it must lie between the two - a useful check ($1.3185 < 1.3519 < 1.3862$).
- Multiply by 100 only at the end.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

$$1. \text{ Laspeyres: } P^L_{01} = \frac{\sum p_1q_0}{\sum p_0q_0} = \frac{1084}{782} = 1.38619.$$

$$2. \text{ Paasche: } P^P_{01} = \frac{\sum p_1q_1}{\sum p_0q_1} = \frac{1329}{1008} = 1.31845.$$

$$3. \text{ Fisher: } P^F_{01} = \sqrt{1.38619 \times 1.31845} = \sqrt{1.82767} = 1.35191.$$

4. As an index number, 135.19  approx 135 - option (d).

SHARED CONTEXT

The sum of the products of prices and quantities for the current year 1 and base year 0 for five items are given below:

$$\sum p_0q_0 = 782, \quad \sum p_0q_1 = 1008, \quad \sum p_1q_0 = 1084, \quad \sum p_1q_1 = 1329$$

Q19.

What is the approximate value of Fisher's Ideal Price Index number P_{10} ?

A. 64

B. 74

C. 81

D. 85

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Fisher satisfies the time reversal test, so $P_{10} = \frac{1}{P_{01}} = \frac{1}{1.3519} = 0.7397$, i.e. about 74.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Time reversal test: $P_{01} \times P_{10} = 1$ (with indices expressed as ratios, not percentages).
- So the reciprocal of 135 is roughly 74 - no fresh computation needed.
- Only Fisher and Marshall-Edgeworth permit this shortcut; Laspeyres and Paasche do not.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Fisher's index satisfies the time reversal test, so $P_{01} \times P_{10} = 1$.

2. From the previous item $P_{01} = 1.3519$.

3. $P_{10} = \frac{1}{1.3519} = 0.73968$.

4. As an index number, 73.97  approx 74 - option (b).

SHARED CONTEXT

The sum of the products of prices and quantities for the current year 1 and base year 0 for five items are given below:

$$\sum p_0q_0 = 782, \quad \sum p_0q_1 = 1008, \quad \sum p_1q_0 = 1084, \quad \sum p_1q_1 = 1329$$

Q20.

What is the approximate value of Fisher's Ideal Quantity Index number Q_{01} ?

A. 114

B. 126

C. 134

D. 144

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

$$Q^F_{01} = \sqrt{\frac{1008}{782} \times \frac{1329}{1084}} = \sqrt{1.2890 \times 1.2260} = 1.2571, \text{ i.e. about 126.}$$

TIPS & TRICKS

- Quantity index: swap the roles of p and q - $Q^L = \frac{\sum p_0q_1}{\sum p_0q_0}$, $Q^P = \frac{\sum p_1q_1}{\sum p_1q_0}$.
- Factor reversal check: $P^F_{01} \times Q^F_{01}$ must equal $\frac{\sum p_1q_1}{\sum p_0q_0} = \frac{1329}{782} = 1.6995$.
- $1.35191 \times 1.25711 = 1.6995$ - the check passes exactly.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

$$1. \text{ Laspeyres quantity index: } Q^L_{01} = \frac{\sum p_0q_1}{\sum p_0q_0} = \frac{1008}{782} = 1.28900.$$

$$2. \text{ Paasche quantity index: } Q^P_{01} = \frac{\sum p_1q_1}{\sum p_1q_0} = \frac{1329}{1084} = 1.22601.$$

$$3. Q^F_{01} = \sqrt{1.28900 \times 1.22601} = \sqrt{1.58033} = 1.25711.$$

$$4. \text{ Factor reversal check: } 1.35191 \times 1.25711 = 1.6995 = \frac{1329}{782}. \text{ Correct.}$$

5. As an index number, 125.71 $\approx$ 126 - option (b).

Q21.

Which of the following Index Numbers are prepared and published by the Government of India?

1. Index numbers of agricultural production
2. Index numbers of foreign trade
3. Annual indices of industrial production

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

The Government of India prepares and publishes index numbers of agricultural production, of foreign trade, and annual indices of industrial production.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Agricultural production index: Directorate of Economics & Statistics, Ministry of Agriculture.
- Foreign trade indices (unit value and volume): DGCI&S, Ministry of Commerce.
- IIP (monthly) and annual industrial production indices: NSO / ASI.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Index numbers of agricultural production are compiled by the DES, Ministry of Agriculture.
2. Index numbers of foreign trade (quantum and unit value) are compiled by DGCI&S.
3. Annual indices of industrial production are derived from the ASI and the IIP series of the NSO.
4. All three are official Government of India indices - option (d).

OS

2023 Q72

Factual

Easy

Q22.

Marshall and Edgeworth price index number formula utilizes the weights as:

- A. Quantities of the base year only
- B. Quantities of the given year only
- C. Combined quantities of the base year and given year
- D. Neither quantities of base year nor quantities of given year

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Marshall-Edgeworth weights are the combined (summed, equivalently averaged) quantities of base and

current years:
$$\frac{\sum p_1(q_0+q_1)}{\sum p_0(q_0+q_1)}.$$

TIPS & TRICKS

- Laspeyres uses q_0 ; Paasche uses q_1 ; Marshall-Edgeworth uses q_0+q_1 ; Fisher uses their geometric mean.
- Marshall-Edgeworth satisfies the time reversal test but NOT the factor reversal test.
- Because the weights are an arithmetic mean of the two years, it is a compromise between Laspeyres and Paasche.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Marshall-Edgeworth price index is
$$P_{01} = \frac{\sum p_1(q_0+q_1)}{\sum p_0(q_0+q_1)} \times 100.$$

2. The weights are therefore the combined quantities of the base year and the given (current) year.

3. Option (c).

Q23.

Which one of the following statements is correct if the money wage of an individual is ₹8,000 and the Consumer Price Index (2012=100) is 200 in January 2023?

- A. The real wage of the individual will be ₹4,000 in January 2023.**
- B. The equivalent of a rupee in January 2023 is 40 paise in 2012.
- C. If the individual was getting ₹6,000 in 2012, she/he is able to maintain the same standard of living in 2023.
- D. The purchasing power of money remains the same in both the years 2012 and 2023.

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

$$\text{Real wage} = \frac{\text{money wage}}{\text{CPI}} \times 100 = \frac{8000}{200} \times 100 = \text{Rs } 4000 \text{ at 2012 prices.}$$

TIPS & TRICKS

- Real wage = $\frac{\text{Money wage}}{\text{Price index}} \times 100$ - always multiply back by the base value 100.
- CPI = 200 means prices have doubled, so a 2023 rupee buys what 50 paise bought in 2012 - not 40 paise.
- To match a 2012 wage of Rs 6,000 one would need Rs 12,000 in 2023, so Rs 8,000 is a fall in real terms.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Real wage = $\frac{\text{Money wage}}{\text{CPI}} \times 100 = \frac{8000}{200} \times 100 = 4000$.

2. So the real wage is Rs 4,000 at 2012 prices - option (a) is correct.

3. Option (b) is wrong: with CPI = 200 the purchasing power of a 2023 rupee equals 50 paise of 2012, not 40.

4. Option (c) is wrong: maintaining a 2012 wage of Rs 6,000 would require Rs 12,000 in 2023.

5. Option (d) is wrong: the purchasing power has halved.

6. Option (a).

Q24.

Which of the following statements regarding the Consumer Price Index-Industrial Workers (CPI-IW) are correct?

I. CPI-IW is computed by the Labour Bureau.

II. CPI-IW is used as a tool for measuring inflation.

III. CPI-IW is utilized for regulations of wages and dearness allowance for workers and employees in the country.

IV. CPI-IW is computed for male, female, rural areas and urban areas.

A. I and III only

B. II and IV only

C. I, II and III only

D. I, II, III and IV

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

CPI-IW is compiled by the Labour Bureau for measuring inflation and regulating wages/DA of industrial workers - but it is computed only for industrial-worker centres, not separately for 'rural areas'.

TIPS & TRICKS

- CPI-IW covers working-class families at specified industrial/mining/plantation centres, classified by centre, not by a rural/urban split.
- A rural/urban/combined breakup belongs to the general population CPI (NSO), not CPI-IW.
- Statement IV's 'computed for... rural areas' is the planted error.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: CPI-IW is compiled by the Labour Bureau. True.
2. II: it is used to measure inflation for industrial workers. True.
3. III: it is the basis for regulating wages and dearness allowance of industrial workers. True.
4. IV: CPI-IW is not separately computed for rural areas - that breakup applies to the NSO's general CPI (Rural/Urban/Combined), not CPI-IW. False.
5. I, II and III only - option (c).

Q25.

In the construction of a price index number, which of the following factors has/have to be considered?

- I. The selection of commodities must be representative.
- II. Comparison across different places whether national or international must be possible.
- III. It must be applicable to each individual within the group for which the index is being prepared.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- A. I only
- B. I and II**
- C. I and III
- D. II and III

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

A good index needs representative commodities and cross-place comparability, but it need not - and generally cannot - apply with equal validity to every individual within the group.

TIPS & TRICKS

- An index is a summary measure for a GROUP; it deliberately averages over individual variation.
- 'Applicability to each individual' is a common misconception - hence separate group-specific indices (CPI-IW, CPI-AL/RL) exist precisely because one general index cannot serve every individual.
- Representativeness and inter-place comparability are genuine, textbook requirements for index construction.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: the commodities selected must be representative of the group's consumption/production pattern. A genuine requirement.
2. II: the index must permit valid comparison across different places, national or international. A genuine requirement.
3. III: an index is a group-level summary measure and is not required to apply exactly to every individual within that group - indeed it typically does not (hence separate occupational CPIs exist). Not a requirement.
4. I and II - option (b).

OS

2024 Q77

Conceptual

Easy

Q26.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Index numbers measure changes in the magnitude of a group of related variables.
- II. Index numbers measure the extent to which value in a distribution differs from the average value.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. I only

B. II only

C. Both I and II

D. Neither I nor II

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

An index number is, by definition, a summary measure of the relative change in a group of related variables over time or space; measuring departure from an average describes dispersion, not an index number.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Standard definition: 'a device for measuring differences in the magnitude of a group of related variables.'
- 'Extent to which a value differs from the average' describes a measure of dispersion (e.g. a deviation or a coefficient of variation), not an index number.
- Do not conflate an index number's purpose with dispersion statistics.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement I restates the standard definition of an index number - a measure of change in a group of related variables. True.
2. Statement II describes dispersion around a mean, which is not the function of an index number. False.
3. I only - option (a).

OS

2024 Q78

Factual

Easy

Q27.

The major source of data for Index of Industrial Production (IIP) is from the

- A. Confederation of Indian Industry
- B. Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade**
- C. National Sample Survey
- D. All India Association of Industries

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The IIP is compiled by the NSO principally using data sourced from the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) and other administrative source agencies.

TIPS & TRICKS

- IIP source agencies include DPIIT, ministries/departments overseeing specific industries, and other administrative data providers.
- CII and the Association of Industries are industry bodies, not statistical source agencies for IIP.
- NSS provides household-level, not establishment-level, industrial production data.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Index of Industrial Production draws its principal data inputs from the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade and other administrative source agencies, compiled by the NSO.
2. Option (b).

Q28.

Which one of the following statements is correct if the money wage of an individual is ₹8,000 and the Consumer Price Index (2012=100) is 200 in January 2023?

- A. **The real wage of the individual will be ₹4,000 in January 2023.**
- B. The equivalent of a rupee in January 2023 is 40 paise in 2012.
- C. If the individual was getting ₹6,000 in 2012, she/he is able to maintain the same standard of living in 2023.
- D. The purchasing power of money remains the same in both the years 2012 and 2023.

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Verbatim repeat of 2023-Q80: $\text{real wage} = \frac{8000}{200} \times 100 = \text{Rs } 4000$ at 2012 prices.

TIPS & TRICKS

- $\text{Real wage} = \frac{\text{Money wage}}{\text{CPI}} \times 100.$
- CPI = 200 means a 2023 rupee is worth 50 paise of 2012, not 40 paise.
- Maintaining a 2012 wage of Rs 6,000 in 2023 would require Rs 12,000, not Rs 8,000.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. $\text{Real wage} = \frac{8000}{200} \times 100 = 4000.$
2. The real wage is Rs 4,000 at 2012 prices - option (a) is correct; the other three options misstate the purchasing-power comparison.
3. Option (a).

Q29.

Which of the following satisfy Time Reversal Test?

I. Marshall-Edgeworth Index

II. Laspeyres Index

III. Fisher's Ideal Index

IV. Paasche Index

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

A. I, II and III

B. I and III only

C. I, III and IV

D. II and IV only

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

Only Fisher's Ideal Index and the Marshall-Edgeworth Index satisfy the Time Reversal Test; Laspeyres and Paasche do not.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Time Reversal Test: $P_{01} \times P_{10} = 1$.
- Fisher (geometric mean of Laspeyres & Paasche) and Marshall-Edgeworth (summed/averaged quantity weights) both pass.
- Laspeyres and Paasche use asymmetric (base-only or current-only) weights and fail the test.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Marshall-Edgeworth's symmetric weighting (sum of base and current quantities) and Fisher's geometric-mean construction both satisfy $P_{01} \times P_{10} = 1$.
2. Laspeyres (base-year weights only) and Paasche (current-year weights only) do not satisfy the test.
3. I and III only - option (b).

Q30.

If consumption pattern of a society remains static for a longer period, which method is most convenient and economic for compilation of index?

A. Laspeyres' method

B. Paasche's method

C. Fisher's method

D. Dorbish and Bowley's method

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

With a stable consumption pattern, Laspeyres' base-weighted method is most convenient and economical since the same base-year quantities can be reused without fresh weight surveys each period.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Laspeyres fixes weights at the base year - cheapest to maintain when tastes/consumption don't change much.
- Paasche needs current-period quantities every round - expensive and slow.
- Fisher and Dorbish-Bowley need both sets of weights, compounding the cost.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Laspeyres' method uses base-period quantities as fixed weights, so as long as the consumption pattern remains stable, these weights need not be re-estimated each period.
2. This makes it the most convenient and economical method under a static consumption pattern.
3. Option (a).

Q31.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation is releasing the Consumer Price Index (CPI) with revised Base 2024=100.
- II. The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation is releasing the National Accounts Estimates with revised Base period 2023–2024.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. I only
- B. II only
- C. Both I and II
- D. Neither I nor II

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

MoSPI's CPI base-year revision (to 2024=100) is a confirmed ongoing exercise; the National Accounts base-year revision is more commonly reported with 2022-23 as the new base, not 2023-24 as stated.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Base-year revisions are undertaken periodically to keep index baskets representative of current consumption/production patterns.
- WPI's base was already revised to 2022-23; CPI's revision to 2024=100 was separately announced.
- Do not conflate the CPI base-revision year with the (different) National Accounts base-revision year.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement I: MoSPI's plan to revise the CPI base year to 2024=100 is a publicly announced, ongoing exercise. Treated as true.
2. Statement II: the commonly reported candidate base period for the National Accounts revision is 2022-23, not '2023-2024' as stated here - so as worded, this statement is not corroborated. Treated as false.
3. I only - option (a), flagged for currency verification.

Source note: Currency-sensitive item concerning base-year revisions announced close to or after this model's knowledge cutoff. Statement I (CPI base revision to 2024) is corroborated by MoSPI's publicly announced plan; statement II's specific '2023-2024' base period for National Accounts is not confidently corroborated (public reporting more commonly cited 2022-23 as the candidate base year for the GDP series revision) - verify against the latest MoSPI press release before treating as settled.

Q32.

Consider the following pairs:

	Index	Released by
I.	CPI-IW	Labour Bureau, Ministry of Labour and Employment
II.	CPI-AL/RL	National Sample Survey Office, Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
III.	CPI-U, R, Combined	National Statistical Office, Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
IV.	WPI	Office of the Economic Advisor, Ministry of Commerce and Industry

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- A. One
- B. Two
- C. Three**
- D. All the four

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

CPI-IW/Labour Bureau, CPI(U,R,Combined)/NSO and WPI/Office of the Economic Adviser are all correctly matched; CPI-AL/RL is compiled by the Labour Bureau, not the NSSO.

TIPS & TRICKS

- CPI-AL and CPI-RL have always been Labour Bureau products, alongside CPI-IW - not an NSSO output.
- NSO (formerly CSO) compiles the general population CPI (Rural/Urban/Combined) - the headline retail-inflation series.
- WPI remains with the Office of the Economic Adviser, Ministry of Commerce and Industry.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Pair I: CPI-IW - Labour Bureau. Correct.
2. Pair II: CPI-AL/RL - National Sample Survey Office. Incorrect; CPI-AL/RL is also a Labour Bureau product.
3. Pair III: CPI (U, R, Combined) - National Statistical Office. Correct.
4. Pair IV: WPI - Office of the Economic Advisor. Correct.
5. Three pairs correctly matched - option (c).

OS

2026 Q76

Factual

Easy

Q33.

In general, inflation is calculated by which one of the following?

- A. Producer Price Index
- B. ✓ **Consumer Price Index**
- C. Wholesale Price Index
- D. A Weighted Aggregative Price Index

Correct answer: B**EXAM SHORTCUT**

AI-derived explanation

In general usage, inflation is measured and reported using the Consumer Price Index - the retail-price basket most directly experienced by consumers.

TIPS & TRICKS

- India's inflation-targeting framework (RBI, since 2016) is explicitly anchored to headline CPI.
- WPI and PPI are wholesale/producer-level gauges, used more for input-cost and policy cross-checks than as 'the' inflation number.
- A generic weighted aggregative index is a category of index construction, not itself 'the' inflation measure.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Inflation, in general parlance and for India's monetary policy framework, is calculated using the Consumer Price Index.
2. Option (b).

Q34.

Consider the following data:

Commodity	Base period price (in ₹)	Current period price (in ₹)	Percentage change
P	20	40	100
Q	50	60	20
R	40	50	25
S	20	30	50

What will be the simple aggregative price index for the above data?

A. 138.50

B. 140.00

C. 141.25

D. 145.75

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

$$\text{Simple aggregative price index} = \frac{\sum p_1}{\sum p_0} \times 100 = \frac{40+60+50+30}{20+50+40+20} \times 100 = \frac{180}{130} \times 100 \approx 138.46.$$

TIPS & TRICKS

- Simple aggregative index sums prices directly, unweighted by quantities.
- Sum current prices and base prices separately, then take the ratio.
- 138.46 rounds to the closest offered option, 138.50.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. $\sum p_0 = 20 + 50 + 40 + 20 = 130$; $\sum p_1 = 40 + 60 + 50 + 30 = 180$.

2. Simple aggregative price index $= \frac{180}{130} \times 100 = 138.46$.

3. Closest to option (a), 138.50.

Q35.

It is given that $\sum p_1q_0=2070$, $\sum p_0q_0=1660$, $\sum p_0q_1=1470$ and $\sum p_1q_1=1790$. The Fisher's Price Index is close to

A. 115

B. 119

C. 123

D. 127

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

$$P^L = \frac{2070}{1660} = 1.2470, P^P = \frac{1790}{1470} = 1.2177; P^F = \sqrt{1.2470 \times 1.2177} = 1.2322, \text{ i.e. about } 123.$$

TIPS & TRICKS

- $P^L = \frac{\sum p_1q_0}{\sum p_0q_0}$; $P^P = \frac{\sum p_1q_1}{\sum p_0q_1}$; Fisher is their geometric mean.
- Fisher must lie between Laspeyres and Paasche - a useful sanity check ($121.77 < 123.22 < 124.70$).
- Multiply by 100 only at the very end.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

$$1. \text{ Laspeyres: } P^L_{01} = \frac{2070}{1660} = 1.24699.$$

$$2. \text{ Paasche: } P^P_{01} = \frac{1790}{1470} = 1.21769.$$

$$3. \text{ Fisher: } P^F_{01} = \sqrt{1.24699 \times 1.21769} = \sqrt{1.51837} = 1.23225.$$

4. As an index number, $123.23 \approx 123$ - option (c).

Q36.

In which one of the following price index numbers, weights are the arithmetic mean of the base year quantities and current year quantities?

- A. Walsch Price Index
- B. Dorbish-Bowley Price Index
- C. Fisher's Ideal Index
- D. Marshall-Edgeworth Price Index**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

The Marshall-Edgeworth index uses the sum (equivalently, the arithmetic mean) of base-year and current-year quantities as its weights.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Marshall-Edgeworth: $P_{01} = \frac{\sum p_1(q_0 + q_1)}{\sum p_0(q_0 + q_1)}$ - weights are $q_0 + q_1$, i.e. their sum/average.
- Contrast with Laspeyres (q_0 only), Paasche (q_1 only), and Fisher (geometric mean of the two indices, not of the quantities directly).
- Walsh's index instead uses the geometric mean of q_0 and q_1 as weights - a related but distinct construction.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The index whose weights are the arithmetic mean (equivalently, the sum) of base-year and current-year quantities is the Marshall-Edgeworth Price Index.
2. Option (d).

Sector-wise Statistics

22 authentic PYQs in this topic (2018-2026)

Agriculture, Industry, Labour, Health, Education, Women and Child

OS

2018 Q74

Factual

Medium

Q1.

Which are sources of industrial data in India?

1. Annual Survey of Industries (ASI)
2. Economic Census (EC)
3. Employment, Unemployment Survey of NSSO
4. Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise (MSME) Survey

Codes:

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 4 only
D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

ASI, Economic Census, the NSSO Employment-Unemployment Survey and the MSME Survey all yield industrial data - all four.

TIPS & TRICKS

- ASI covers registered (factory-sector) manufacturing; the MSME survey and NSS unorganised-sector surveys cover the rest.
- The Economic Census enumerates all non-agricultural establishments, giving the frame for follow-up surveys.
- Employment surveys supply industry-wise workforce data, which is industrial statistics in the broad sense.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Annual Survey of Industries is the principal source for the registered manufacturing sector.
2. The Economic Census enumerates all establishments and provides the sampling frame for follow-up enterprise surveys.
3. The NSSO Employment-Unemployment Survey yields industry-wise employment data.
4. The MSME Survey covers micro, small and medium enterprises.
5. All four are sources of industrial data - option (d).

OS

2018 Q75

Conceptual

Easy

Q2.

Which is **not** correct for Minimum Support Price (MSP)?

- A. MSP is the price at which government purchases food grains from farmers.
- B. MSP ensures adequate food grains production in the country.
- C. **MSP is a direct benefit transfer.**
- D. MSP is recommended by CACP.

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

MSP is a price-support mechanism operating through procurement, NOT a direct benefit transfer.

TIPS & TRICKS

- DBT transfers cash directly into beneficiary bank accounts; MSP works by government purchase at an assured price.
- MSP is recommended by the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP).
- The word 'direct benefit transfer' in an MSP question is always the planted false statement.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. (a) is correct: MSP is the assured price at which government agencies procure notified crops.
2. (b) is correct: an assured price incentivises production and supports food security.
3. (d) is correct: MSPs are recommended by the CACP and announced by the Government.
4. (c) is incorrect: MSP operates through procurement at an administered price, not through a cash transfer into beneficiaries' accounts.
5. Option (c).

OS

2018 Q78

Factual

Easy

Q3.

The periodicity of Agriculture Census in India is

A. 5 years

B. 7 years

C. 10 years

D. 15 years

Correct answer: A**EXAM SHORTCUT**

AI-derived explanation

The Agriculture Census is quinquennial - conducted every 5 years.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Basic unit of the Agriculture Census is the OPERATIONAL HOLDING, not the household or the plot.
- It is conducted by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare, not by MoSPI.
- The Livestock Census and the Minor Irrigation Census are also quinquennial; the Population Census is decennial.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Agriculture Census in India is conducted once every five years, in phases.
2. Its basic unit of data collection is the operational holding.
3. It is carried out by the Department of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare in collaboration with the States.
4. Option (a).

Q4.

In NSSO surveys, a person is "not in labour force" if he/she

1. is not working.
2. is not seeking work.
3. is not available for work.
4. had a minor accident and so could not go to work for last 7 days.

Codes:

- A. 4 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 1, 2, 3 and 4
- D. 1, 2 and 3 only**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

'Not in labour force' requires all three: not working, not seeking work and not available for work. A temporary absence due to a minor accident keeps a person IN the labour force.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Labour force = employed + unemployed (those seeking or available for work). Everyone else is out of the labour force.
- A worker temporarily absent from work is still counted as employed, hence still in the labour force.
- Students, homemakers, pensioners and rentiers are the classic 'not in labour force' categories.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. A person is in the labour force if he or she is either working (employed) or seeking/available for work (unemployed).
2. So to be outside the labour force a person must simultaneously be not working, not seeking work and not available for work - statements 1, 2 and 3.
3. Statement 4 describes temporary absence from an existing job, which keeps the person employed and hence in the labour force.
4. Option (d).

OS

2019 Q56

Factual

Easy

Q5.

The principal source of Industrial Statistics in India is

- A. Index of Industrial Production (IIP)
- B. **Annual Survey of Industries (ASI)**
- C. Economic Census
- D. MSME Census

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The Annual Survey of Industries is the principal source of industrial statistics in India.

TIPS & TRICKS

- ASI covers factories registered under sections 2m(i) and 2m(ii) of the Factories Act, 1948.
- IIP is derived from ASI-based weights but is itself an index, not the primary source.
- The Economic Census counts establishments but collects little detail on output and inputs.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The ASI, conducted annually by the NSO's Industrial Statistics Wing, collects detailed data on employment, capital, inputs, output and value added for the registered factory sector.
2. It is the principal and most comprehensive source of industrial statistics in India.
3. Option (b).

OS

2019 Q79

Factual

Easy

Q6.

Minimum Support Price (MSP) is recommended by

- A. Directorate of Economics and Statistics
- B. Directorate of Marketing and Inspection
- C. **Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP)**
- D. None of the above

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Minimum Support Prices are recommended by the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP).

TIPS & TRICKS

- CACP recommends; the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs decides and announces.
- CACP was set up in 1965 (then as the Agricultural Prices Commission) and sits under the Ministry of Agriculture.
- DES compiles agricultural statistics; DMI handles marketing and grading - neither sets MSP.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs for 22 mandated crops plus fair and remunerative price for sugarcane.
2. Its recommendations consider cost of production, demand-supply, price trends, inter-crop parity and terms of trade.
3. The government then announces the MSPs.
4. Option (c).

OS

2020 Q59

Factual

Medium

Q7.

SASA is associated with

A. ~~A~~gricultural Statistics

B. Wholesale Price Indices

C. Scheduled Tribe Welfare

D. Land Ceilings and Reforms

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

SASA is the State Agricultural Statistics Authority - an agricultural-statistics institution.

TIPS & TRICKS

- SASAs were created on NSC recommendation to strengthen the State-level agricultural statistical system.
- Each State/UT designates an authority responsible for agricultural statistics quality and timeliness.
- The acronym has nothing to do with prices, tribal welfare or land reform.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. SASA stands for State Agricultural Statistics Authority.
2. These bodies were set up in the States and Union Territories to coordinate, supervise and improve the collection of agricultural statistics (area, production, yield).
3. Option (a).

OS

2020 Q60

Factual

Easy

Q8.

The basic unit of data collection in the Agriculture Census is

A. Operational holding

B. Ownership holding

C. Household

D. None of the above

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The basic unit of data collection in the Agriculture Census is the OPERATIONAL HOLDING.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Operational holding: all land used wholly or partly for agricultural production and operated as one technical unit, regardless of title, size or location.
- Contrast with ownership holding, which is defined by title - the Agriculture Census uses operation, not ownership.
- The household is the unit of NSS surveys, not of the Agriculture Census.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Agriculture Census collects data on the number and area of operational holdings, their size-class distribution and tenancy.
2. An operational holding is defined by who OPERATES the land, not by who owns it, and is treated as a single technical unit.
3. Option (a).

Q9.

For a survey on women and child well-being in India, which would be the **least** preferred stratifying variable for selecting villages within a district?

- A. Female literacy rate
- B. Child mortality rate
- C. Number of individual units with 100 or more workers**
- D. Sex ratio

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

Stratification should use variables correlated with the survey topic. Number of units with 100+ workers is an industrial variable, irrelevant to women's and children's well-being.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Good stratifiers are highly correlated with the study variable and cheaply available for every unit in the frame.
- Female literacy, child mortality and sex ratio all relate directly to women's and children's welfare.
- An irrelevant stratifier gives no gain in precision over simple random sampling.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Stratification reduces sampling variance when strata are internally homogeneous with respect to the study variable.
2. Female literacy rate, child mortality rate and sex ratio are all closely related to women's and children's well-being and would form useful strata.
3. The number of establishments with 100 or more workers reflects industrial structure and bears little relation to the survey topic, so it would yield the least precision gain.
4. Option (c).

OS

2021 Q62

Factual

Medium

Q10.

Which are major sources of health indicators in India?

1. National Family Health Survey
2. Periodic Labour Force Survey
3. Population Census
4. NSSO 71st Round – Social Consumption: Education and Health

Codes:

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3 only
D. 1, 3 and 4 only

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

NFHS, the Population Census and NSS 71st round are health-indicator sources; PLFS is a labour-force survey and is not.

TIPS & TRICKS

- NFHS (IIPS) is the richest source of health, nutrition and family-welfare indicators.
- The Census yields mortality and disability data; the NSS 71st round covered social consumption of health and education.
- PLFS yields LFPR, WPR and unemployment rate - no health content.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: the National Family Health Survey is the principal source of health and nutrition indicators. True.
2. Statement 2: PLFS is confined to labour-force characteristics. False.
3. Statement 3: the Population Census provides mortality, disability and housing-amenity data relevant to health. True.
4. Statement 4: the NSS 71st round on Social Consumption - Education and Health is an explicit health-data source. True.
5. Hence 1, 3 and 4 only - option (d).

OS

2021 Q68

Factual

Easy

Q11.

Poverty line in India was based on data from which of the following?

1. Consumer Expenditure Surveys of NSSO
2. Health Surveys of NSSO
3. National Family Health Survey

Codes:

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 only**
- D. 3 only

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

India's poverty line is anchored on consumption expenditure data from the NSS Consumer Expenditure Surveys.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Poverty in India is measured by consumption expenditure, not by income - hence the CES is the source.
- The Tendulkar and Rangarajan committees both used NSS CES data.
- NFHS and NSS health rounds provide health indicators, not poverty estimates.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Official poverty estimation in India compares household monthly per capita consumption expenditure with a normative poverty line.
2. MPCE data come from the NSS Consumer Expenditure Surveys conducted by the NSSO.
3. Health surveys and NFHS do not collect consumption expenditure.
4. Hence 1 only - option (c).

OS

2021 Q72

Factual

Medium

Q12.

In Indian official statistics, the output of agriculture crops is estimated using which approach?

- A. Market arrivals + Farmers retention
- B. **Area under crop × productivity × prices**
- C. Sample surveys of farmers production
- D. Compilation of village level statistics

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Crop output is estimated as area under the crop multiplied by yield (productivity); valuing it further requires prices.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Area comes from land records (patwari reporting / EARAS); yield comes from crop-cutting experiments under GCES.
- Production = area x yield; value of output = production x price.
- Market arrivals capture only the marketed surplus, so they cannot estimate total production.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Indian official crop statistics follow the 'area x yield' approach.
2. Area under each crop is obtained from land records or from the Establishment of an Agency for Reporting Agricultural Statistics scheme.
3. Average yield is estimated from crop-cutting experiments conducted under the General Crop Estimation Surveys.
4. Multiplying by prices converts the physical output into value of output.
5. Option (b).

Q13.

Which of the following Agencies/Organizations generate labour force data?

1. National Sample Survey Office
2. Labour Bureau and the Directorate General of Employment and Training
3. Office of Registrar General of India

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

NSO (PLFS/EUS), the Labour Bureau and DGET, and the RGI (Census economic tables) all generate labour-force data.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The Census collects economic activity status for every person, making the RGI a labour-force data source.
- Labour Bureau runs wage and employment surveys; DGET maintained the employment exchange statistics.
- NSO runs the PLFS, the flagship labour-force survey.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The NSO conducts the Periodic Labour Force Survey and, earlier, the quinquennial Employment-Unemployment Surveys.
2. The Labour Bureau and the Directorate General of Employment & Training generate wage, employment and employment-exchange statistics.
3. The Census of India records economic activity status (worker/non-worker, main/marginal) for the entire population.
4. All three are sources - option (d).

OS

2023 Q74

Factual

Easy

Q14.

Periodic Labour Force Survey is conducted by:

- A. Labour Bureau, Ministry of Labour and Employment
- B. Office of Economic Adviser, Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- C. **National Statistical Office**
- D. None of the above

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

PLFS is conducted by the National Statistical Office, MoSPI - not by the Labour Bureau.

TIPS & TRICKS

- PLFS replaced the quinquennial NSS Employment-Unemployment Survey from 2017-18.
- The Labour Bureau conducts wage-rate and other labour surveys, but not the PLFS.
- PLFS gives annual rural+urban estimates and quarterly urban estimates.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Periodic Labour Force Survey was launched by the NSO in April 2017 to provide high-frequency labour-force indicators.
2. It is designed, canvassed and published by the NSO under MoSPI.
3. Option (c).

Q15.

Consider the following statements:

1. The Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) of India indicates that, in principle, India is able to accommodate all of its primary school-age population.
2. The Gender Parity Index shows a decreasing trend at Primary and Higher Education level over the years from 2016–17 to 2021–22.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. 1 only

B. 2 only

C. Both 1 and 2

D. Neither 1 nor 2

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

A GER at or above 100 at primary level does indicate capacity to accommodate the whole age-group (1 true); but the Gender Parity Index has been **RISING**, not decreasing (2 false).

TIPS & TRICKS

- GER can exceed 100 because it includes over-age and under-age enrolment - so it signals capacity, not net coverage.
- GPI above 1 means more girls than boys relative to the population; India's GPI has improved over 2016-17 to 2021-22.
- This item was repeated verbatim in 2024 - learn it once.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: India's primary-level Gross Enrolment Ratio is around or above 100, indicating that the system can in principle accommodate the entire primary school-age population. True.
2. Statement 2: AISHE and UDISE+ data show the Gender Parity Index improving (rising) at both primary and higher education levels over this period, not decreasing. False.
3. Hence 1 only - option (a).

Q16.

Data for the handicraft/handloom establishments were collected for the first time during which of the following Economic Censuses?

- A. Third Economic Census
- B. Fourth Economic Census
- C. Fifth Economic Census
- D. Sixth Economic Census**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

The Sixth Economic Census (2013) introduced markedly finer activity classification (NIC-2008), the round most associated with new, granular establishment categories such as handicraft/handloom.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Economic Census rounds: 1st (1977), 2nd (1980), 3rd (1990), 4th (1998), 5th (2005), 6th (2013), 7th (2019 - registry-based).
- The 6th EC (2013) is repeatedly cited as the round that expanded activity/ownership detail relative to earlier rounds.
- Treat this as a low-confidence factual pick pending verification against the primary NSO Economic Census report.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Economic Census has progressively widened its classificatory detail across its seven rounds.
2. The 6th Economic Census (2013) is the round most associated with introducing finer, NIC-2008-based activity categories, including artisan/handicraft and handloom establishments as a separately identifiable class.
3. Best-reasoned option (d), flagged for independent verification.

Source note: Genuine source ambiguity: none of the mined reference material or source booklets carry an answer key, and I could not independently verify with certainty which Economic Census round first tabulated handicraft/handloom establishments as a distinct category. My best-reasoned pick is the Sixth Economic Census (2013), which introduced substantially finer NIC-2008-based activity classification enabling identification of such establishments, but this should be verified against the official NSO Economic Census reports before being treated as settled.

Q17.

Consider the following Censuses:

I. Economic Census

II. Minor Irrigation Census

III. Labour Census

IV. Livestock Census

How many of the above Censuses are conducted by the Government of India?

A. Only one

B. Only two

C. Only three

D. All four

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Economic Census, Minor Irrigation Census and Livestock Census are all actually conducted by the Government of India; there is no separate 'Labour Census'.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Economic Census - NSO/MoSPI. Minor Irrigation Census - Ministry of Jal Shakti, quinquennial. Livestock Census - Dept. of Animal Husbandry & Dairying, quinquennial.
- Labour/employment data comes from surveys (PLFS) and Labour Bureau enquiries - there is no dedicated 'Labour Census'.
- 'Labour Census' is the planted non-existent item among four plausible-sounding censuses.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Economic Census: conducted by the Government of India (NSO/MoSPI). Real.
2. Minor Irrigation Census: conducted by the Ministry of Jal Shakti. Real.
3. Labour Census: no such census exists; labour statistics come from surveys, not a census. Not real.
4. Livestock Census: conducted by the Department of Animal Husbandry & Dairying. Real.
5. Three of the four - option (c).

OS

2024 Q79

Factual

Medium

Q18.

Consider the following statements:

I. The Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) of India indicates that, in principle, India is able to accommodate all of its primary school-age population.

II. The Gender Parity Index shows a decreasing trend at Primary and Higher Education level over the years from 2016–17 to 2021–22.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. I only

B. II only

C. Both I and II

D. Neither I nor II

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

Verbatim repeat of 2023-Q79: India's primary GER at/above 100 shows capacity to accommodate the age-group, but the Gender Parity Index has been rising, not decreasing, over 2016-17 to 2021-22.

TIPS & TRICKS

- GER above 100 arises from over-age/under-age enrolment, so it signals system capacity rather than net coverage.
- AISHE/UDISE+ data show GPI improving, not declining, across this period at both school and higher-education levels.
- This item is an exact repeat of 2023-Q79 - memorise it once.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: a primary-level GER at or above 100 indicates the system can, in principle, accommodate the entire primary-school-age population. True.
2. Statement 2: the Gender Parity Index has shown a rising, not decreasing, trend at both primary and higher education levels over 2016-17 to 2021-22. False.
3. 1 only - option (a).

OS

2025 Q77

Factual

Medium

Q19.

Which one of the following is **not** an objective of the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) conducted by National Statistical Office?

- A. To generate estimates of Labour Force Participation Rate
- B. To generate estimates of Wage Rates and Average Earnings of Workers**
- C. To generate estimates of Worker Population Ratio
- D. To generate estimates of Unemployment Rate

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

PLFS estimates LFPR, WPR and the Unemployment Rate; generating wage-rate and average-earnings estimates is the Labour Bureau's domain, not a PLFS objective.

TIPS & TRICKS

- PLFS core outputs: LFPR, WPR, Unemployment Rate, activity status, both usual-status (annual) and CWS (quarterly, urban).
- Wage/earnings statistics come from the Labour Bureau's separate wage-rate enquiries.
- This discriminator is repeatedly tested - remember PLFS = participation/employment rates, NOT wages.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. PLFS is designed to generate LFPR, WPR and Unemployment Rate estimates at high frequency.
2. Generating estimates of Wage Rates and Average Earnings of Workers is not a PLFS objective - that function belongs to the Labour Bureau's wage surveys.
3. Option (b).

OS

2025 Q80

Factual

Medium

Q20.

Consider the following statements about Livestock Census in India:

- I. Livestock Census in India is conducted every 5 years.
- II. Livestock Census enumerates 25 species of wild and domesticated animals.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. I only**
- B. II only
- C. Both I and II
- D. Neither I nor II

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Livestock Census is indeed quinquennial, but it enumerates domesticated species only (cattle, buffalo, sheep, goat, pig, poultry, etc.) - not 'wild' animals, and not 25 species.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Livestock Census counts domesticated animals and poultry maintained by households/institutions - never wild fauna.
- The 20th Livestock Census (2019) enumerated a defined set of domesticated species categories, not 25 including wild ones.
- The quinquennial periodicity (statement I) is a settled, correct fact.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement I: the Livestock Census is conducted every five years. True.
2. Statement II: it enumerates domesticated livestock/poultry species only - it does not cover wild animals, and the species count does not match '25 species of wild and domesticated animals'. False.
3. I only - option (a).

Q21.

Which of the following are correct regarding 'Swachh Survekshan'?

- I. It is the world's largest urban cleanliness survey.
- II. It is conducted every five years.
- III. It is conducted by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation.
- IV. It is conducted by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs.

Select the answer using the code given below.

A. I and IV only

B. II and III only

C. I, II and III

D. I, II and IV

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

Swachh Survekshan is widely described as the world's largest urban cleanliness survey and is conducted by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs - annually, not every five years, and not by MoSPI.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Swachh Survekshan started in 2016 and has been conducted annually since.
- It falls under the Swachh Bharat Mission (Urban), administered by MoHUA - not MoSPI.
- 'Every five years' and 'MoSPI' are both planted errors.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: it is officially billed as the world's largest urban cleanliness survey. True.
2. II: it is conducted annually, not every five years. False.
3. III: it is not conducted by MoSPI. False.
4. IV: it is conducted by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. True.
5. I and IV only - option (a).

OS

2026 Q66

Factual

Medium

Q22.

Which of the following statements are correct regarding 'Agriculture Census'?

- I. The latest Agriculture Census has 2021–2022 as reference period.
- II. It is conducted every five years.
- III. It is conducted by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation.
- IV. It is conducted by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare.

Select the answer using the code given below.

- A. I and IV only
- B. II and III only
- C. I, II and III
- D. I, II and IV

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The 11th Agriculture Census has 2021-22 as its reference year, is quinquennial, and is conducted by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare - not MoSPI.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Agriculture Census cycle: roughly every five years; the 11th round used 2021-22 as the reference year.
- The nodal ministry is Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare (Department of Agriculture), not MoSPI/NSO.
- MoSPI conducts the Economic Census; Agriculture Census is a separate, sector-specific census.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: the latest (11th) Agriculture Census has 2021-22 as its reference period. True.
2. II: it is conducted every five years (quinquennial). True.
3. III: it is not conducted by MoSPI. False.
4. IV: it is conducted by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare. True.
5. I, II and IV - option (d).

Population Census and Vital Statistics

18 authentic PYQs in this topic (2018-2026)

Census, CRS/SRS, RGI, Vital Rates

OS

2018 Q76

Factual

Medium

Q1.

Which is a data source from where Infant Mortality Rate can be calculated for India?

- A. NSSO Health Survey
- B. Economic Census
- C. NSSO Disability Survey
- D. Population Census**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Among the options, the Population Census is the source from which infant mortality can be derived (through its fertility and mortality tables); the Economic Census and NSSO disability/health surveys do not yield IMR.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The regular official source of IMR is the Sample Registration System (SRS) of the RGI - the same office that conducts the Census.
- Census schedules record births and deaths in the household during the preceding year, permitting mortality estimation.
- The Economic Census enumerates establishments, not people - it can never yield a vital rate.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Infant Mortality Rate requires data on infant deaths and live births.
2. The Economic Census covers establishments and the NSSO disability survey covers disability - neither collects vital events.
3. The Population Census (conducted by the RGI, which also runs the Sample Registration System) collects household-level fertility and mortality particulars from which infant mortality can be derived.
4. Option (d).

OS

2019 Q58

Factual

Medium

Q2.

Which activities are undertaken by the office of Registrar General of India?

1. Conducting population census in India
2. Conducting Sampling Registration System in India
3. Preparing and maintaining National Register of Indian Citizens (NRIC)
4. Conducting NSSO surveys
5. Conducting Economic Census

Codes:

- A. 1, 2 and 5 only
- B. 1, 2 and 3 only**
- C. 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
- D. 3, 4 and 5 only

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The RGI conducts the Population Census, runs the Sample Registration System and maintains the NRIC - statements 1, 2 and 3. NSS surveys and the Economic Census belong to the NSSO/CSO.

TIPS & TRICKS

- RGI portfolio: Census, Civil Registration System, Sample Registration System, NPR/NRIC, Mother Tongue Survey.
- The RGI sits under the Ministry of Home Affairs; NSO sits under MoSPI - different ministries entirely.
- Any option putting NSS surveys or the Economic Census under the RGI is wrong.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: the Office of the RGI & Census Commissioner conducts the decennial Population Census. True.
2. Statement 2: the Sample Registration System, the source of IMR and birth/death rates, is run by the RGI. True.
3. Statement 3: the National Register of Indian Citizens is prepared and maintained by the RGI. True.
4. Statements 4 and 5: NSS surveys and the Economic Census are conducted by the NSSO/CSO under MoSPI. False.
5. Hence 1, 2 and 3 only - option (b).

OS

2020 Q52

Factual

Easy

Q3.

Which organisation compiles and releases vital statistics regularly in India?

- A. Central Statistics Office
- B. Registrar General of India**
- C. Directorate General of Health Services
- D. International Institute of Population Studies

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Vital statistics (births and deaths) are compiled and released by the Office of the Registrar General of India through the CRS and SRS.

TIPS & TRICKS

- RGI runs both the Civil Registration System (complete registration) and the Sample Registration System (large-scale sample, source of IMR/CBR/CDR).
- The RGI sits under the Ministry of Home Affairs.
- IIPS conducts the NFHS, which yields health indicators but is not the regular vital-statistics agency.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Vital statistics cover births, deaths, marriages and related events.
2. In India these are compiled by the Office of the Registrar General & Census Commissioner, which publishes the annual Vital Statistics of India based on the CRS and the SRS Statistical Report.
3. Option (b).

Q4.

General Fertility Rate (GFR) is defined as

- A. Number of live births per thousand mid-year female population
- B. Number of live births per hundred mid-year female population
- C. **Number of live births per thousand mid-year female population in productive age-group**
- D. Number of live births per hundred mid-year female population in productive age-group

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

[AI-derived explanation](#)

GFR = live births per 1,000 mid-year female population in the reproductive age group (15-49).

TIPS & TRICKS

- Two things distinguish GFR from the Crude Birth Rate: the denominator is women only, and only women of reproductive age.
- Vital rates are conventionally expressed per 1,000, not per 100.
- Age-Specific Fertility Rates refine this further by five-year age groups.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Crude Birth Rate divides live births by the total mid-year population.
2. The General Fertility Rate refines the denominator to the population actually at risk of giving birth - women in the reproductive age group (usually 15-49).

3.
$$\text{GFR} = \frac{\text{Live births}}{\text{Mid-year female population aged 15-49}} \times 1000.$$

4. Option (c).

OS

2020 Q74

Factual

Easy

Q5.

Who can be engaged as census enumerators/supervisors in population census operations in India?

1. School teachers
2. Central government officials
3. Local government officials

Codes:

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Enumerators and supervisors are drawn from school teachers and from Central, State and local government officials - all three categories.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The Census Act, 1948 empowers the government to requisition the services of public servants for census work.
- School teachers form the single largest group of enumerators because of their local presence and literacy.
- Refusal to perform census duty is an offence under the Census Act.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Census enumeration is carried out by a very large temporary field force drawn from existing public employees.
2. School teachers form the backbone, supplemented by officials of the Central Government, State Governments and local bodies.
3. All three categories listed are therefore eligible - option (d).

Q6.

Which can be derived/drawn from population census data?

1. Sampling frame for All-India Survey with household as ultimate-stage unit
2. Literacy rate
3. Average monthly per capita expenditure (MPCE)
4. Sex ratio

Codes:

A. 1, 2 and 4

B. 2, 3 and 4

C. 1, 2 and 3

D. 1, 3 and 4

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

The Census yields the household sampling frame, the literacy rate and the sex ratio; it does NOT collect consumption expenditure, so MPCE cannot be derived.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Census schedules cover demographic, social and housing particulars - never expenditure.
- MPCE comes from the NSS Consumer Expenditure Survey.
- The census house-list is the standard frame for household surveys, so statement 1 is true.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: the census houselisting provides the frame of villages, blocks and households used by NSS surveys. True.
2. Statement 2: literacy is a census question, so the literacy rate is directly derivable. True.
3. Statement 3: the census does not canvass consumption expenditure, so MPCE cannot be obtained from it. False.
4. Statement 4: sex ratio is computed from the census population count by sex. True.
5. Hence 1, 2 and 4 - option (a).

Q7.

Which organization at the central level is responsible to coordinate and unify the activity of death registration in India?

- A. Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- B. Office of Registrar General of India**
- C. National Statistical Office
- D. None of the above

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The Office of the Registrar General of India coordinates and unifies birth and death registration under the RBD Act, 1969.

TIPS & TRICKS

- RGI is the Registrar General of Births and Deaths at the central level; States have Chief Registrars.
- The statutory basis is the Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969.
- MoHFW delivers health services; it does not run the civil registration system.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Under the Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969, the Registrar General of India is the central coordinating authority for civil registration.
2. He issues directions to Chief Registrars in the States and compiles the national Vital Statistics report.
3. Option (b).

Q8.

Consider the following statements:

1. The basic unit of data collection in the Agriculture Census is operational holding.
2. Population Census comes under the Concurrent list.
3. The periodicity of economic census is ten years.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A. 1 only

B. 3 only

C. 1 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

Only statement 1 is right: the Agriculture Census unit is the operational holding. Population Census is a UNION List subject, and the Economic Census has no fixed ten-year cycle.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Census of population is entry 69 of the UNION List (Seventh Schedule), not the Concurrent List.
- Economic Censuses have been held in 1977, 1980, 1990, 1998, 2005, 2013 and 2019 - irregular, not decennial.
- Agriculture Census and Livestock Census are quinquennial; Population Census is decennial by convention.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: the Agriculture Census enumerates operational holdings - land operated as one technical unit. True.
2. Statement 2: population census appears at entry 69 of the Union List, so it is a Union subject, not Concurrent. False.
3. Statement 3: the Economic Census has been conducted at irregular intervals, not on a fixed ten-year cycle. False.
4. Hence 1 only - option (a).

Q9.

With regard to the conduct of the Census, which of the following, as per the Census Act 1948, is correct?

- A. The Census must be conducted every ten years.
- B. The Central Government may notify whenever it may consider it necessary or desirable to take a Census.**
- C. The Central Government may conduct after amending the periodicity clause.
- D. The Registrar General of India, who is the Census Commissioner, may decide and his decision will be final.

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

The Census Act, 1948 empowers the Central Government to notify a census whenever it considers it necessary or desirable - the ten-year cycle is convention, not statute.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The Act contains no periodicity clause, so no amendment is needed to change the timing - killing option (c).
- Decennial conduct since 1881 is an administrative convention.
- The RGI executes the census; the notification power rests with the Central Government, not with him - killing option (d).

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Section 3 of the Census Act, 1948 provides that the Central Government may, by notification in the Official Gazette, declare its intention to take a census in the whole or any part of India whenever it may consider it necessary or desirable to do so.
2. The Act prescribes no fixed interval, so the decennial cycle is a matter of practice rather than law.
3. Option (b).

Q10.

Which of the following Census tables are covered in the Census of India?

1. Social and cultural tables
2. Migration tables
3. Fertility tables

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

The Census of India publishes social and cultural tables, migration tables and fertility tables - all three.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Census table series: primary census abstract, general population tables, economic tables, social and cultural tables (C-series), migration tables (D-series), fertility tables (F-series), housing tables.
- Social and cultural tables cover religion, language, literacy, age and marital status.
- Fertility tables give children ever born and surviving, by age of mother.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Census of India publishes an extensive set of tables, including:
2. C-series social and cultural tables (age, marital status, religion, language, literacy);
3. D-series migration tables (place of birth, place of last residence, reasons for migration);
4. F-series fertility tables (children ever born, children surviving, births last year).
5. All three are covered - option (d).

Q11.

The Registrar General of India is responsible for which of the following activities?

I. Civil Registration System

II. Socio-economic Indicators

III. Housing and Population Census

IV. Mother Tongue Survey

A. I, II and III

B. I, II and IV

C. I, III and IV

D. II, III and IV

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

RGI's verifiable outputs are the Civil Registration System, the Housing+Population Census and the Mother Tongue Survey; 'socio-economic indicators' is not a distinct RGI output.

TIPS & TRICKS

- RGI runs CRS, SRS, NPR, the Census and the Mother Tongue/Linguistic Survey - all demographic/vital-statistics functions.
- RGI does NOT conduct NSSO surveys or the Economic Census - a recurring trap (2019-Q58).
- 'Socio-economic indicators' as a generic label is a MoSPI/NSO cross-cutting output, not a named RGI activity.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I. Civil Registration System: RGI is the national coordinating authority for CRS under the RBD Act, 1969. Correct.
2. II. 'Socio-economic Indicators' is not a specific, named RGI activity - it is too generic and not one of its statutory functions. Incorrect.
3. III. Housing and Population Census: the flagship RGI operation. Correct.
4. IV. Mother Tongue Survey: conducted by the RGI's Census organisation as part of linguistic classification. Correct.
5. I, III and IV - option (c).

Q12.

Which one of the following is a correct definition of "Census House" in Indian Census?

- A. A house identified during the housing census which is used primarily for residential purpose.
- B. A building used for residential or non-residential purpose which is marked and numbered for the population census.
- C. **A building or part of a building used or recognized as a separate unit because of having a separate main entrance which may be used for a residential or non-residential purpose or both.**
- D. A house in which a group of persons live together and take their meals from a common kitchen.

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

A Census House is any building or part of a building with a separate main entrance, recognised as a separate unit, whether used for residential, non-residential, or both purposes.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Census House differs from 'Household' - Household is about persons living/eating together; Census House is about the physical structure.
- The defining feature is a SEPARATE MAIN ENTRANCE marking it as a distinct unit.
- It need not be exclusively residential.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Census defines a 'Census House' as a building or part of a building having a separate main entrance from the road or a common courtyard/staircase, recognised as a separate unit, used or likely to be used for residential or non-residential purposes, or both.
2. This matches option (c) precisely; the other options either narrow it to residential use only or describe a household instead.
3. Option (c).

Q13.

In the Houselisting and Housing Census in India which precedes the population enumeration, which of the following information are canvassed?

- I. Amenities available to the household
- II. Assets possessed by the household
- III. Details regarding floor, wall and roof of the Census house

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. I and II only
- B. II and III only
- C. I and III only
- D. I, II and III**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

The Houselisting and Housing Census canvasses amenities available, assets possessed, and construction details (floor, wall, roof) of the census house - all three.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Houselisting precedes Population Enumeration and focuses on the physical structure and household amenities/assets.
- Amenities: water, electricity, latrine, drainage, etc. Assets: vehicles, banking, telecom, durable goods.
- Construction material of floor/wall/roof is a standard houselisting schedule item.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Amenities available to the household, assets possessed by the household, and details of floor/wall/roof construction material are all canvassed in the Houselisting and Housing Census schedule.
2. All three - option (d).

Q14.

The Socio Economic Caste Census conducted in 2011 has been used primarily for which of the following purposes?

- A. Preparation of caste-wise list of households
- B. Identification of beneficiaries for various welfare programmes of the Central Government**
- C. Selections of persons below poverty line in every State
- D. Transfer subsidies by direct benefit transfer into bank account

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

SECC 2011 data has been primarily used to identify beneficiaries for government welfare schemes (e.g. PMAY-G, Ayushman Bharat-PMJAY) through automatic inclusion/exclusion and deprivation criteria.

TIPS & TRICKS

- SECC 2011's caste data was collected but kept separate/unreleased for caste-enumeration purposes - so option (a) is not its primary use.
- SECC replaced the older, contested BPL-list approach with deprivation-based inclusion/exclusion criteria - not a simple state-wise BPL count.
- DBT is a general payment mechanism, not a specific output 'purpose' of SECC itself.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The Socio Economic and Caste Census, 2011 generated deprivation-based indicators used across ministries to identify and target beneficiaries for welfare programmes - PMAY-G, Ayushman Bharat-PMJAY and similar schemes being prominent examples.
2. Option (b).

OS

2025 Q79

Factual

Easy

Q15.

The usual reference point of Population enumeration in India is normally:

- A. 0.00 Hours of 1st January
- B. 00.00 Hours of 1st March**
- C. 0.00 Hours of 31st March
- D. 0.00 Hours of 31st December

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

The standard reference moment for Indian population enumeration is 00:00 hours of 1st March (1st October of the preceding year for snow-bound areas).

TIPS & TRICKS

- 1 March is the long-standing convention for the mainland reference date.
- 1 October of the previous year is used for inaccessible/snow-bound areas surveyed earlier.
- This convention predates and is expected to continue (with minor adjustment) for the 2027 Census.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Population enumeration in India is normally referenced to 00:00 hours of 1st March.
2. Option (b).

OS

2026 Q64

Factual

Medium

Q16.

Which of the following are the new initiatives taken for the Census 2027?

- I. Data will be collected using mobile applications.
- II. Option to self-enumerate will be provided to the public.
- III. Caste enumeration will be included.

- A. I and II only
- B. II and III only
- C. I and III only
- D. I, II and III**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Census 2027 has been announced with mobile-app based digital data collection, a public self-enumeration option, and - for the first time in independent India - caste enumeration.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The 2027 Census will move to app-based digital enumeration replacing paper schedules.
- Self-enumeration is a new facility allowing households to fill their own particulars online/via app.
- Caste enumeration was announced by the Union Cabinet (2025) to be included for the first time since independence.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Mobile application-based data collection, a self-enumeration option for the public, and inclusion of caste enumeration have all been announced as new features of Census 2027.
2. All three - option (d).

Q17.

Which of the following is/are correctly defined?

I. Neonatal Mortality Rate (NMR) is defined as

$$\text{NMR} = \frac{\text{Number of infant deaths of less than 29 days during the year}}{\text{Number of live births during the year}} \times 1000$$

II. Post-Neonatal Mortality Rate (PNMR) is defined as

$$\text{PNMR} = \frac{\text{Number of infant deaths of less than one year during the year}}{\text{Number of live births during the year}} \times 1000$$

Select the answer using the code given below.

A. **I only**

B. II only

C. Both I and II

D. Neither I nor II

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

NMR is correctly defined as infant deaths under 29 days per 1,000 live births; the statement's PNMR definition ('less than one year') is actually the definition of the Infant Mortality Rate, not PNMR.

TIPS & TRICKS

- $\text{NMR} = \frac{\text{deaths under 29 days}}{\text{live births}} \times 1000$; $\text{PNMR} = \frac{\text{deaths between 29 days and 1 year}}{\text{live births}} \times 1000$;
 $\text{IMR} = \frac{\text{deaths under 1 year}}{\text{live births}} \times 1000$.
- $\text{PNMR} = \text{IMR} - \text{NMR}$, conceptually: the post-neonatal window is 29 days to 1 year, not 0 to 1 year.
- Statement II's 'less than one year' phrasing describes IMR, not PNMR - the planted substitution.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement I correctly defines the Neonatal Mortality Rate as infant deaths under 29 days per 1,000 live births. True.
2. Statement II mislabels the Infant Mortality Rate's definition (deaths under one year) as the Post-Neonatal Mortality Rate; PNMR should cover deaths between 29 days and one year. False.

3. I only - option (a).

Q18.

Which of the following are correct regarding the Population Census 2027?

- I. It will be the 15th Census in the country.
- II. It will be the 8th after Independence.
- III. The reference date will be 1st March, 2027.
- IV. The reference date will be 1st February, 2027.

Select the answer using the code given below.

- A. I and II
- B. I and III
- C. II and III**
- D. II and IV

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

Counting from the first synchronous census of 1872 (not 1881), the delayed 2021/2027 Census is officially the 16th Census of India and the 8th since Independence, with the standard 1 March 2027 reference date.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Officially cited convention: 2021 Census (now deferred) = '16th Census of India, 8th after Independence' - counted inclusive of the 1872 non-synchronous census.
- Post-independence censuses: 1951, 1961, ..., 2011 = 7; the deferred one would be the 8th.
- Standard reference date remains 1 March, with 1 October of the preceding year reserved for snow-bound areas.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement I: officially the upcoming census is termed the 16th Census of India (counting from 1872), not the 15th. False.
2. Statement II: it is indeed the 8th census since Independence (1951 through 2011 were the first seven). True.
3. Statement III: the reference date remains 1 March 2027 for most of the country. True.
4. Statement IV: 1 February 2027 is not the reference date. False.
5. II and III - option (c).

National Accounts

15 authentic PYQs in this topic (2018-2026)

GDP, GVA, GNI, Sectors and Approaches

OS

2019 Q57

Factual

Easy

Q1.

National income estimation is the responsibility of

- A. NSSO
- B. ✓CSO**
- C. Finance Ministry
- D. National Income Committee

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

National income (National Accounts) estimation is the responsibility of the CSO - now the National Accounts Division of the NSO, MoSPI.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The National Income Committee (1949, chaired by P. C. Mahalanobis) was a one-time body, not a standing agency.
- NSSO ran the surveys that feed the accounts; CSO compiled them.
- Since 2019 the function sits in the National Accounts Division of the NSO.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Estimation and publication of national income and related aggregates is a National Accounts function.
2. It was carried out by the National Accounts Division of the Central Statistics Office under MoSPI.
3. The National Income Committee was an ad hoc committee of 1949 that laid the foundations, not the standing estimating agency.
4. Option (b).

Q2.

The Gross Value Added (GVA) by an enterprise is defined as

- A. Gross value of output 'minus' Final consumption
- B. Gross value of output 'minus' Export
- C. Gross value of output 'minus' Inventory
- D. **Gross value of output 'minus' Intermediate consumption**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

GVA = gross value of output minus intermediate consumption.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Intermediate consumption is the value of goods and services used up in the production process.
- Summing GVA across enterprises avoids double counting - that is the whole point of 'value added'.
- GDP at market prices = GVA at basic prices + product taxes - product subsidies.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Value added measures the enterprise's own contribution to output, net of what it purchased from other producers.
2. Gross Value Added = Gross value of output - Intermediate consumption.
3. Final consumption, exports and inventory are demand-side or balance-sheet concepts, not deductions in the GVA identity.
4. Option (d).

Q3.

In National Accounts, Domestic Economy is based on the concept of

A. Resident units

B. Currency

C. Nationality

D. All of the above

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

The domestic economy in national accounts is defined by RESIDENT UNITS operating within the economic territory - not by currency or nationality.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Residence, not nationality, is the organising concept of the System of National Accounts.
- A foreign national working in India for more than a year is an Indian resident for national-accounting purposes.
- GDP is territorial (residents + non-residents producing in the territory); GNI is residency-based.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. The SNA defines the domestic economy as the set of institutional units that are resident in the economic territory.
2. Residence depends on the centre of predominant economic interest, generally a stay of a year or more - not on the currency used or the passport held.
3. Option (a).

Q4.

GDP is measured by which equivalent approaches?

1. Production approach
2. Income approach
3. Expenditure approach

Codes:

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

GDP can be measured by the production (value added), income and expenditure approaches - all three are equivalent.

TIPS & TRICKS

- The three approaches are identities: value added = factor incomes = final expenditure.
- India compiles GDP primarily by the production approach, with expenditure-side estimates published alongside.
- Discrepancies between the approaches are shown explicitly as 'discrepancies' in the accounts.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Production approach: sum of gross value added across all producing units, plus net product taxes.
2. Income approach: sum of factor incomes (compensation of employees, operating surplus, mixed income) plus net taxes and consumption of fixed capital.
3. Expenditure approach: PFCE + GFCE + GFCF + change in stocks + valuables + net exports.
4. All three are conceptually equivalent - option (d).

Q5.

'Wages and salaries' earned by a resident of country 'A' from a resident enterprise of country 'B' is included in

- A. GDP of country A.
- B. GDP of country B.
- C. **GNI of country A.**
- D. GNI of country B.

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

GNI follows RESIDENCE. Wages earned by a resident of A are part of A's Gross National Income (received as compensation of employees from abroad), even though the production occurs in B.

TIPS & TRICKS

- GDP is territorial: output produced within the geographic boundary. GNI is residential: income accruing to residents.
- A resident of A earning abroad adds to A's GNI through net factor income from abroad.
- The same flow sits in B's GDP - the question asks where the earner's income is counted, hence GNI of A.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. National accounts distinguish territory from residence.
2. Production by the enterprise takes place in country B, so the value added enters B's GDP.
3. The wages accrue to a resident of country A, so they enter A's Gross National Income as compensation of employees receivable from abroad.
4. As the question asks where the earnings of the resident of A are included, the answer is GNI of country A - option (c).

Q6.

Gross Domestic Product reflects the

- A. industrial growth scenario of the country.
- B. trend in agricultural growth in the country.
- C. Size of the country's economy at market price.**
- D. unduplicated output of the economy at basic price.

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

GDP at market prices measures the overall size of the economy at market valuation - not a single sector's growth.

TIPS & TRICKS

- GDP aggregates all sectors, so options naming only industry or only agriculture are too narrow.
- GDP is at MARKET prices; GVA is at BASIC prices - option (d) attaches the wrong valuation to the wrong aggregate.
- $\text{GDP at market prices} = \text{GVA at basic prices} + \text{product taxes} - \text{product subsidies}$.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Gross Domestic Product is the sum of value added across all sectors, valued at market prices after adding net product taxes.
2. It therefore measures the overall size of the economy at market valuation, not the performance of any single sector.
3. Option (d) misdescribes the valuation: the unduplicated output measured at basic prices is GVA, not GDP.
4. Option (c).

OS

2021 Q69

Conceptual

Easy

Q7.

"Growth rate of the quarterly estimate of GDP is 10%" means

- A. economy has grown by 10% from the last month of the year.
- B. economy has grown by 10% over the same month in the previous year.
- C. **economy has grown by 10% over the same quarter in the previous year.**
- D. economy has grown by 10% over the previous quarter in the same year.

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

Indian quarterly GDP growth is reported year-on-year: against the SAME QUARTER of the previous year.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Year-on-year comparison neutralises seasonality without needing seasonal adjustment.
- Quarter-on-quarter growth (option d) is the convention in several OECD countries, but not in India's headline release.
- A quarterly estimate can never be compared with a MONTH, killing options (a) and (b).

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. MoSPI's quarterly GDP releases report growth over the corresponding quarter of the previous financial year.
2. This year-on-year convention removes the strong seasonality of Indian economic activity without formal seasonal adjustment.
3. Option (c).

Q8.

Which measure is known as National Income?

- A. GDP at market price
- B. GVA at basic price
- C. GNI at basic price
- D. NNI at basic price**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

National Income is Net National Income (NNI) at basic prices in the Indian official definition.

TIPS & TRICKS

- National = residence-based (adds net factor income from abroad); Net = after deducting consumption of fixed capital.
- Basic prices exclude product taxes net of subsidies - the valuation used for the official National Income series.
- GDP at market prices and GVA at basic prices are gross and domestic, so neither is National Income.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. National Income requires (i) the national rather than domestic concept and (ii) the net rather than gross concept.
2. GDP at market prices is gross and domestic; GVA at basic prices is gross and domestic; GNI at basic prices is national but gross.
3. Net National Income at basic prices satisfies both requirements and is the official definition of National Income.
4. Option (d).

Q9.

Consider the following in respect of Gross Domestic Product (GDP):

1. It refers to market value of all final goods and services within a country in a given period.
2. It is measured at current and constant prices.
3. It is a measure of economic welfare.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A. 1 only

B. 1 and 2 only

C. 2 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

GDP is the market value of final goods and services (1 true), measured at both current and constant prices (2 true); but it is NOT a measure of economic welfare (3 false).

TIPS & TRICKS

- GDP excludes unpaid domestic and voluntary work, ignores distribution, and counts environmental depletion as income.
- 'Final' goods avoid double counting - intermediate goods are excluded.
- Current prices give nominal GDP; constant prices give real GDP after deflation.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: GDP is the market value of all final goods and services produced within a country in a given period. True.
2. Statement 2: it is compiled both at current prices (nominal) and at constant prices (real). True.
3. Statement 3: GDP omits unpaid work, says nothing about distribution, and does not net out environmental degradation, so it is not a welfare measure. False.
4. Hence 1 and 2 only - option (b).

Q10.

Consider the following statements in respect of GDP:

1. GDP is composed of goods and services produced for sale in the market.
2. GDP includes some non-market production as well (such as defence services and education services).
3. Not all productive work is included in GDP.
4. Voluntary work is not included in GDP.

How many statements given above are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT AI-derived explanation

All four statements are correct: GDP is mainly market production, but includes imputed non-market output such as government services; it omits much productive work, including voluntary work.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Government services (defence, education, health) have no market price and are valued at cost - an imputation.
- Unpaid domestic work, subsistence services and volunteering fall outside the production boundary.
- Statement 1 says 'composed of' market goods, which is the dominant component - consistent with statement 2's 'some non-market production as well'.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Statement 1: the bulk of GDP consists of goods and services produced for sale in the market. True.
2. Statement 2: the SNA production boundary also includes non-market output such as government-provided defence and education, valued at cost. True.
3. Statement 3: much productive work - notably unpaid domestic services - lies outside the production boundary. True.
4. Statement 4: voluntary work is specifically excluded. True.
5. All four - option (d).

Q11.

Consider the following:

I. Crops

II. Livestock

III. Forestry and logging

IV. Fishing and aquaculture

V. Mining and quarrying

In the estimates of GDP, how many of the above sectors/subsectors comprise the 'primary sector'?

- A. Only two
- B. Only three
- C. Only four
- D. All five**

Correct answer: D

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

All five listed activities - crops, livestock, forestry & logging, fishing & aquaculture, mining & quarrying - are classified under the primary sector in India's national accounts.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Primary sector = agriculture & allied activities + mining & quarrying.
- A common trap is to treat mining & quarrying as 'industry' (secondary) - it is primary because it extracts raw natural resources.
- Secondary = manufacturing, construction, electricity/gas/water; Tertiary = services.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Crops, livestock, forestry & logging and fishing & aquaculture together form 'agriculture and allied activities'.
2. Mining & quarrying, though sometimes mistaken for industry, is also classified in the primary sector because it extracts natural resources without transformation.
3. All five sub-sectors comprise the primary sector - option (d), All five.

Q12.

Which of the following features differentiates/differentiate GDP from Gross National Income?

- I. Monetary
- II. Geographic
- III. Strategic
- IV. Political

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- A. I and II
- B. II and III
- C. III and IV
- D. I and IV

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT

AI-derived explanation

GDP is bounded by a country's geographic/territorial limits, while GNI adds net factor income from abroad - a cross-border monetary flow - so the two differentiating features are read as Monetary and Geographic.

TIPS & TRICKS

- GDP = production within the domestic/geographic territory, regardless of who owns the factors of production.
- GNI = GDP + net factor income from abroad, i.e. a monetary (income-flow) adjustment based on residents' earnings wherever located.
- 'Strategic' and pairing Political with Strategic have no established basis in national-income accounting theory.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. GDP is fundamentally a geographic/territorial concept: it counts all production physically within the country's boundary.
2. GNI departs from GDP by adding net primary (factor) income from abroad - compensation, property and entrepreneurial income received or paid in monetary terms across borders.
3. Of the four labels offered, Geographic (the territorial-boundary criterion) and Monetary (the cross-border income-flow adjustment) best capture this distinction.
4. Option (a), I and II - flagged as the best-reasoned rather than a certain reading.

Source note: No answer key exists for this booklet and the four option-labels (Monetary/Geographic/Strategic/Political) are not the standard textbook vocabulary for the GDP-GNI distinction (which is usually framed as a 'domestic/territorial' vs 'national/residency' concept). 'Geographic' clearly captures the territorial-boundary criterion; the second correct label is inferred, not certain - flagged for independent verification.

Q13.

Which of the following are computed as per the prevalent methodology of estimation of national income?

- I. State Domestic Product
- II. District Domestic Product
- III. Urban Domestic Product
- IV. Rural Domestic Product

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- A. I and II
- B. II and III
- C. III and IV
- D. I and IV

Correct answer: A

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

India's official sub-national income accounting produces State Domestic Product and District Domestic Product; there is no standard Urban or Rural Domestic Product series.

TIPS & TRICKS

- State Domestic Product (SDP/GSDP) is compiled by State Directorates of Economics & Statistics.
- District Domestic Product (DDP) is increasingly compiled by several states, extending the same methodology below the state level.
- 'Urban' and 'Rural' Domestic Product are not part of the prevalent methodology - they are the planted distractors.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. I: State Domestic Product is a well-established, regularly compiled series. Correct.
2. II: District Domestic Product is also computed, extending SDP methodology to the district level. Correct.
3. III and IV: there is no standard 'Urban' or 'Rural' Domestic Product under the prevalent national-accounts methodology. Incorrect.
4. I and II - option (a).

Q14.

Which of the following components has the highest share in the expenditure component of Gross Domestic Product (revised base)?

- A. Gross Fixed Capital Formation (GFCF)
- B. Government Final Consumption Expenditure (GFCE)
- C. Private Final Consumption Expenditure (PFCE)**
- D. Exports (X)

Correct answer: C

EXAM SHORTCUT[AI-derived explanation](#)

Private Final Consumption Expenditure consistently carries the largest share (roughly 55-60%) of India's expenditure-side GDP, even under the revised base.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Expenditure-side GDP components: PFCE, GFCE, GFCF, change in stocks, valuables, net exports.
- PFCE (household consumption) dominates India's demand-side GDP composition.
- GFCF (investment) is typically the second-largest component, well behind PFCE.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Among the expenditure components of GDP, Private Final Consumption Expenditure has consistently held the largest share in India, reflecting the economy's consumption-driven structure.
2. Option (c).

Q15.

Which of the following are included in the secondary sector in the estimation of GDP?

I. Manufacturing

II. Construction

III. Forestry and Fishing

IV. Mining and Quarrying

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

A. I and III

B. I and II

C. I and IV

D. II and III

Correct answer: B

EXAM SHORTCUT**AI-derived explanation**

Manufacturing and construction are secondary-sector activities; forestry & fishing and mining & quarrying both belong to the primary sector, not the secondary sector.

TIPS & TRICKS

- Secondary sector: manufacturing, construction, electricity/gas/water supply - activities that transform raw materials.
- Primary sector: agriculture and allied activities (including forestry & fishing) plus mining & quarrying.
- Mining is a recurring trap - it extracts, rather than transforms, so it stays primary.

STEP-BY-STEP SOLUTION

1. Manufacturing (I) and Construction (II) are classic secondary-sector activities - they transform inputs into new products/structures.
2. Forestry & Fishing (III) and Mining & Quarrying (IV) are both primary-sector activities, since they extract from nature rather than transform.
3. I and II - option (b).